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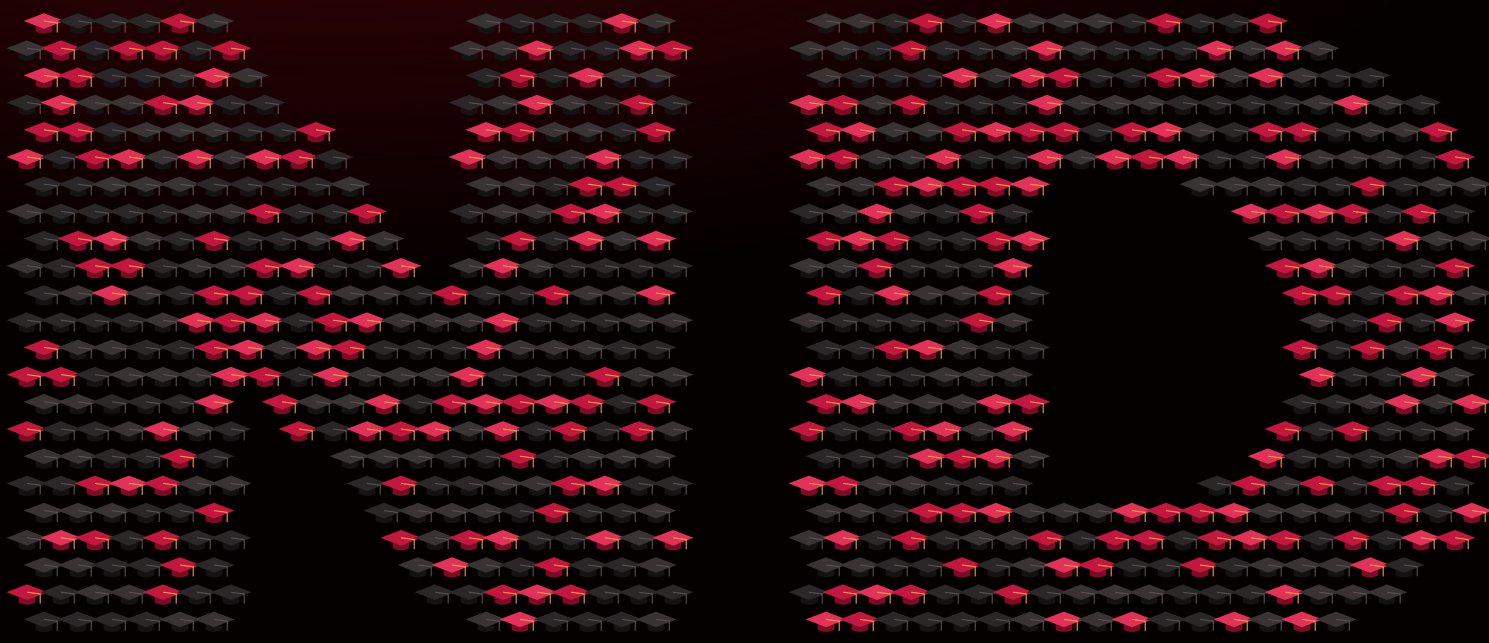
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NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 North Dakota Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston
Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **36 in every 100**, mark the international share of North Dakota's STEM master's degrees.



The 2026 North Dakota Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

NOVEMBER 2026

A publication jointly produced by the Hoover Institution and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence at Stanford University.

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Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to North Dakota: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

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Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from federal sources: the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, as the backbone, together with NAEP, NSF's surveys of graduate students, doctorates and research funding, USAspending.gov, DHS and ICE SEVIS data, the Department of Labor, USCIS, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, and USPTO PatentsView. Each figure names its source, and the Sources page lists all of them. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 North Dakota Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What North Dakota's numbers say

1. **International students earn 36% of North Dakota's STEM master's degrees,** 16.2 points below the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 35th of 51 on dependence. The share is 57% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 4.2% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **North Dakota awarded 122 STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 0.1% of the U.S. total and 42nd of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed +27%, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **The heaviest dependence is in engineering,** where international students earned 49% of master's degrees (112 degrees; U.S. 49%). No STEM field with at least 50 master's graduates are majority-international.
4. **Among states of similar size,** North Dakota ranks 3rd of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: North Dakota 36%, South Dakota 48%, Delaware 72%, Montana 18%, Hawaii 16%.
5. **50% of North Dakota's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 3.3% came from abroad. More students arrived from other states (4.13K) than residents left (1.59K), a net gain of 2.54K; the top destination for those leaving was Minnesota.

36%

of the STEM master's degrees North Dakota awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

53.5K #47
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · −0.7% since 2015

122 #42
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · +27% since 2015

36% #35
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · −3.5 pp since 2015

16% #20
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · +1.3 pp since 2015

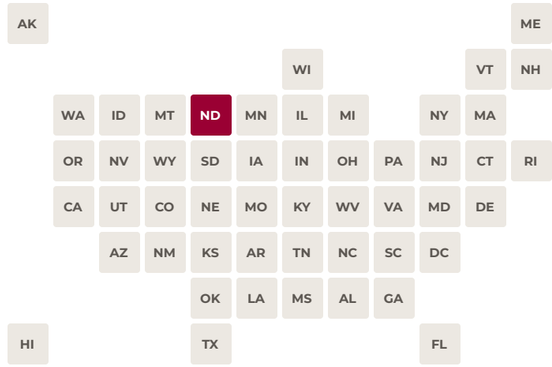
21% #37
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · +0.2 pp since 2015

60% #32
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +9.2 pp since 2015

$11.9K #16
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · −0.6% since 2015

50% #47
First-time students from in state, 2024
−1.0 pp since 2016

$82.6K #42
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · −7.4% since 2016



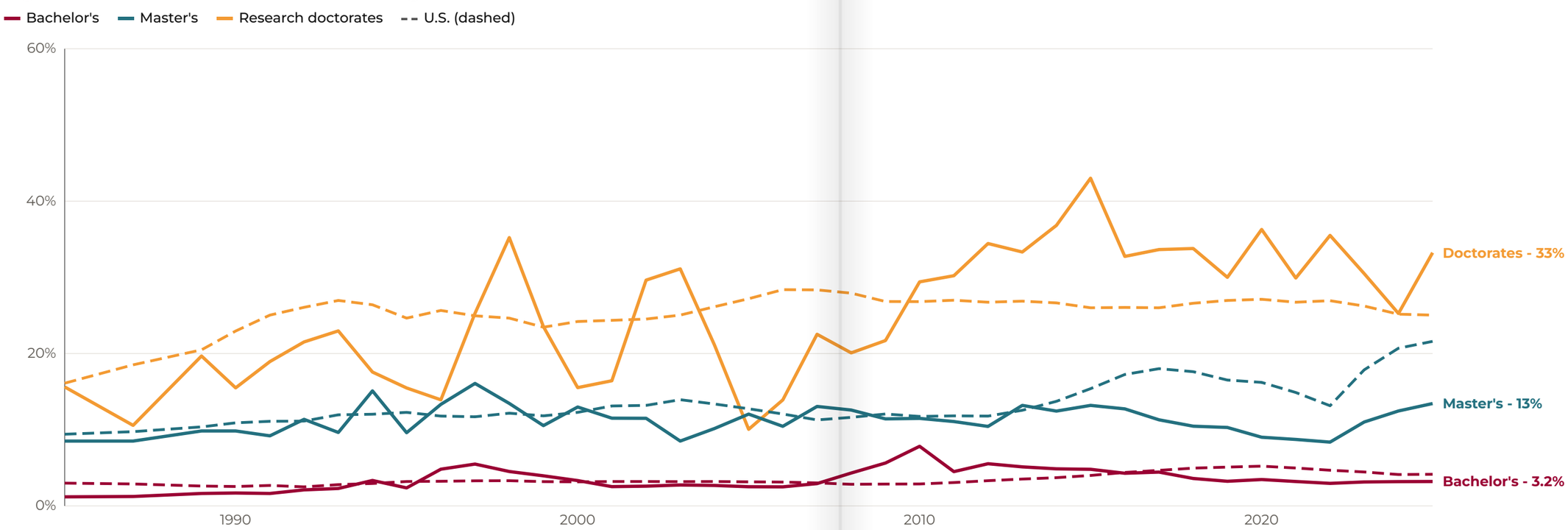
Badges give North Dakota's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

SECTION 1

International Dependence

North Dakota ranks 35th of 51 on the international share of STEM master's, at 36% in 2025 against 52% for the U.S.

Figure 1 What Share of North Dakota's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025.

International students make up 16% of North Dakota's graduate enrollment and 2.7% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 3.2% of bachelor's, 13% of master's and 33% of research doctorates go to international students.

In STEM the shares are higher still: 4.2% of STEM bachelor's, 36% of STEM master's and 57% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 0.1% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 42nd of 51.

16%

Int. share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **20th** of 51 · +1.3 pp since 2015

13%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

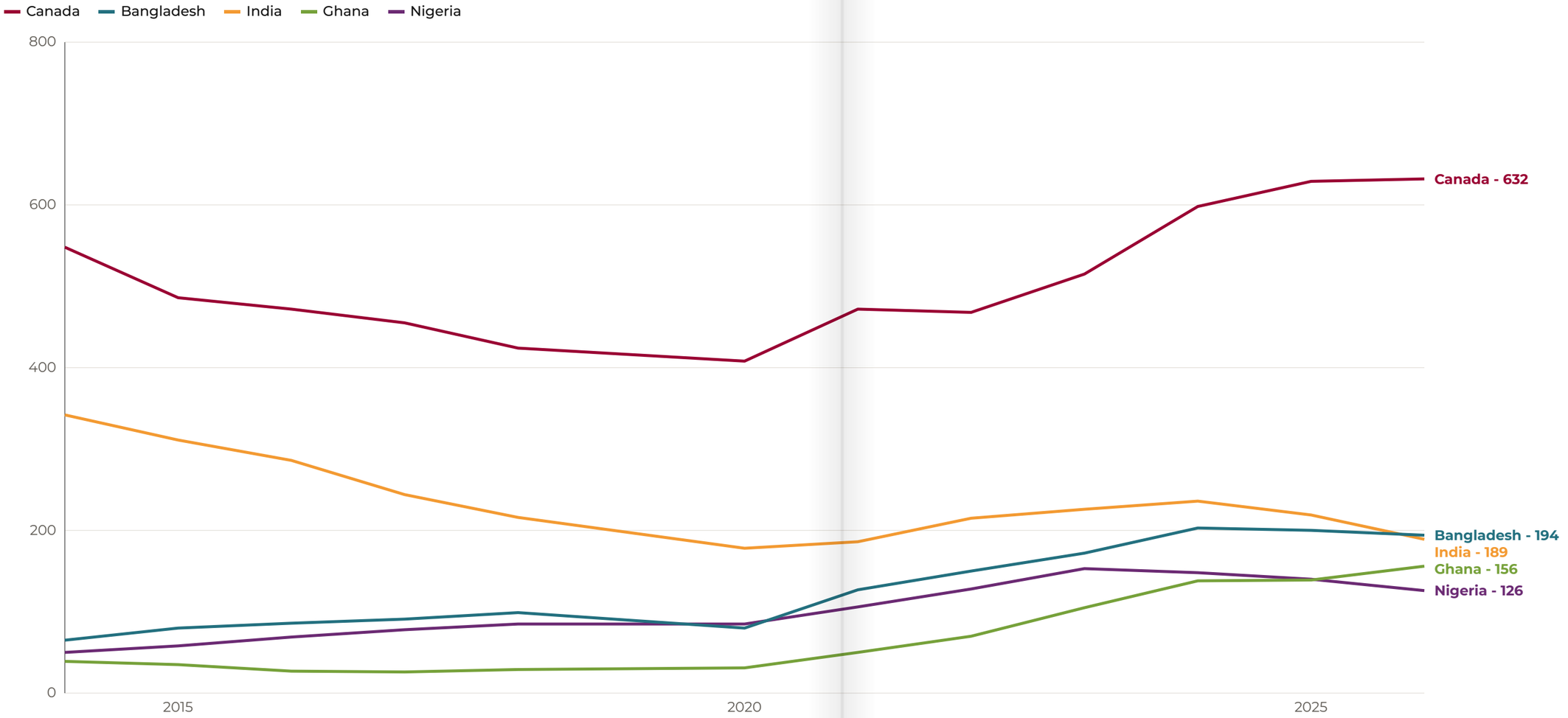
U.S. **22%** · **29th** of 51 · +0.2 pp since 2015

36%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **35th** of 51 · −3.5 pp since 2015

Figure 2 Where Do North Dakota's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

In October 2026, North Dakota had 2.41K active international students in SEVIS, 46th of 51. Canada accounted for 26% of them and Bangladesh for 8.1%, against 3.3% and 2.3% nationally.

Students came from 117 countries, but the two largest supplied 34%. The state's total is down 7% since 2015, when it stood at 2.6K.

2.41K
Active international students, October 2026
46th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

26%
From Canada
U.S. **3.3%**

60%
In STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

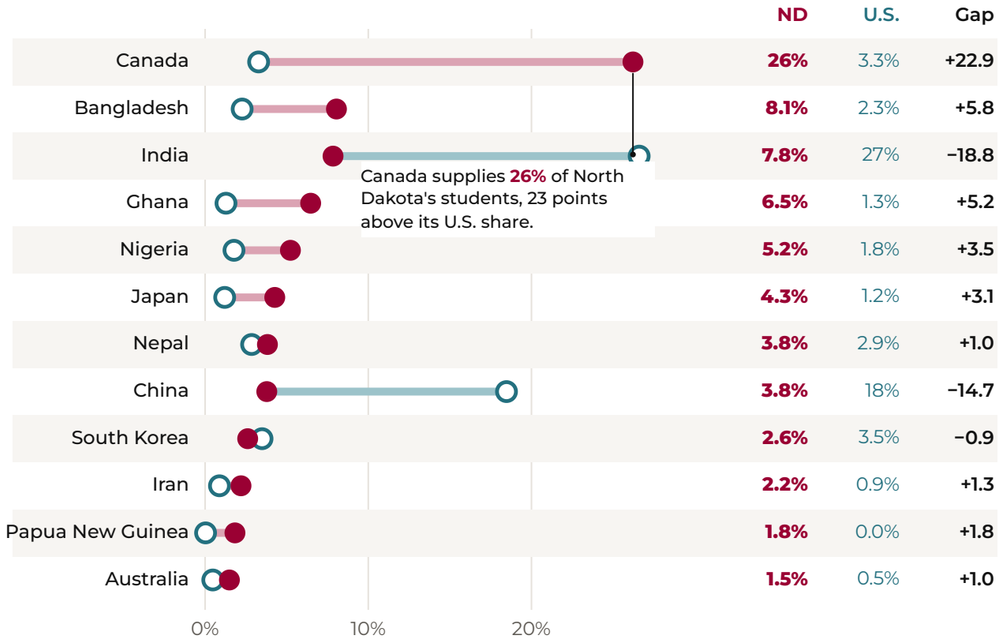
How Does North Dakota's Mix of Countries Compare With the Nation's?

In October 2026, North Dakota had **2.41K** active F-1 and M-1 students, 46th among the 50 states and DC and **0.2%** of the U.S. total. They came from 117 countries.

Canada supplied **26%** of them, against 3.3% nationally, and Bangladesh **8.1%**, against 2.3%. India (7.8%), Ghana (6.5%), and Nigeria (5.2%) followed.

Together the two largest countries supplied **34%** of the state's international students (U.S. 45%), 32nd among the states, against 40% in 2015.

Figure 3 Is North Dakota's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

2.41K
Active international students, October 2026
46th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

26%
From Canada
U.S. **3.3%**

8.1%
From Bangladesh
U.S. **2.3%**

117
Countries represented
U.S. **219**

The state's count is down 1.6% from 2025 and down 7.5% since 2015, when it stood at 2.6K. Its share of all U.S. international students is unchanged since 2015, at **0.2%**.

Since 2015, the number of students from Canada went from 486 to 632, Bangladesh's from 80 to 194, and India's from 311 to 189.

Over the same years, the number from Ghana went from 35 to 156 and Nigeria's from 58 to 126. The table gives each country's count for the first, previous and latest years.

Table 1 International Students in North Dakota, 2015–2026

	2015	2025	2026	Change since 2015	U.S. 2026	Rank
ALL INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS						
Active F-1 and M-1 students	2.6K	2.45K	**2.41K**	−7.5%	1.19M	46th
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.2%	0.2%	**0.2%**	0.0 pp	–	46th
Countries of citizenship represented	111	117	**117**	+5.4%	219	47th
Share from the two largest countries of origin	40%	35%	**34%**	−5.8 pp	45%	32nd
LARGEST COUNTRIES OF CITIZENSHIP (STUDENTS)					**U.S. SHARE**	**STATE SHARE**
Canada	486	629	**632**	+30%	3.3%	26%
Bangladesh	80	200	**194**	+142%	2.3%	8.1%
India	311	219	**189**	−39%	27%	7.8%
Ghana	35	139	**156**	–	1.3%	6.5%
Nigeria	58	140	**126**	+117%	1.8%	5.2%

Active F-1 and M-1 students, one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November; 2019 has none; the latest year is October 2026). Rank among the 50 states and DC. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

Figure 4

Which Countries Supply North Dakota's International STEM Students?

1.45K of North Dakota's international students were in STEM fields in October 2026, **60%** of the total against 63% nationally, up 37% since 2015.

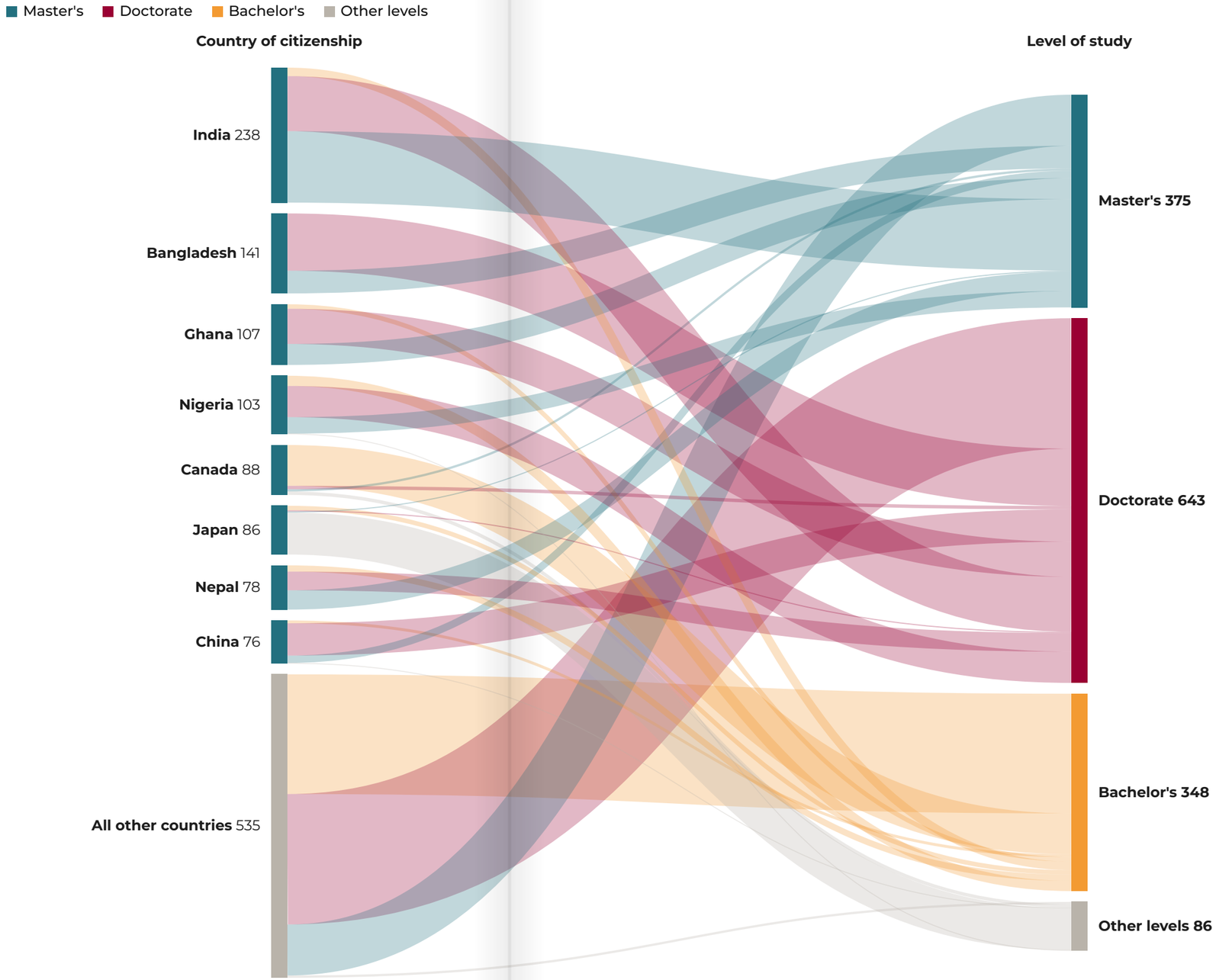
Doctoral students were the largest group, **643**. Bangladesh supplied 16% of them and India 15%.

STEM doctoral students went from 392 in 2015 to **643**, and STEM master's students from 293 to 375.

1.45K
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students, 2026
U.S. **749K** · **44th** of 51 · +37% since 2015

60%
Share in STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

375
Active STEM master's students, 2026
U.S. **393K** · **45th** of 51 · +28% since 2015



Active F-1 and M-1 students in STEM fields by country of citizenship and level of study, October 2026; the eight largest countries are shown. DHS does not draw its STEM pages on the same basis as its all-student pages, so the STEM count here exceeds the all-level count for India (238 against 189). Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

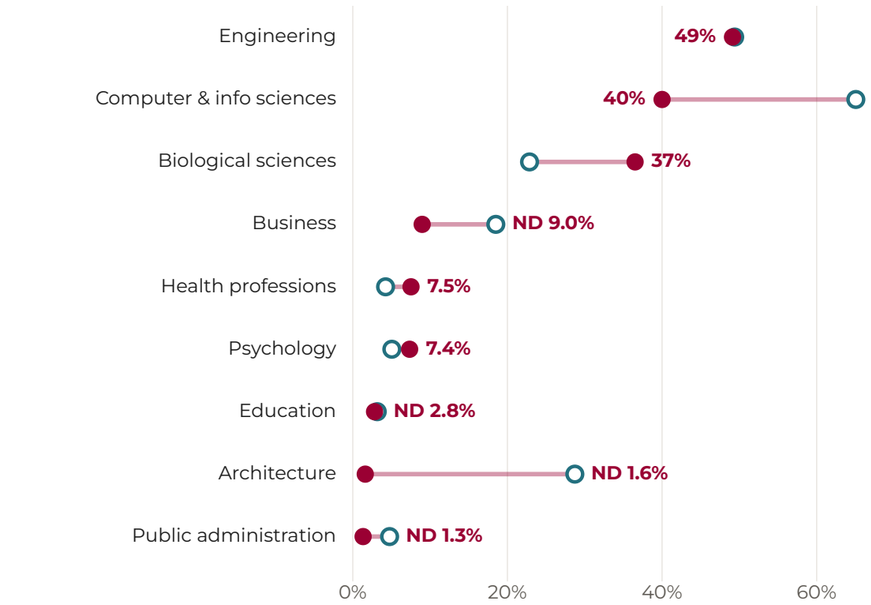
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How International Are North Dakota's Master's Fields?

Each row is a master's field with at least 30 graduates in North Dakota in 2025, ranked by the share of degrees earned by international students (U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas). The filled dot is the state's share; the open dot is the national share for the same field.

Highest international shares. International students earned the largest shares of master's degrees in engineering (49%, against 49% for the U.S.), computer & info sciences (40%, against 65% for the U.S.), and biological sciences (37%, against 23% for the U.S.).

Figure 5 Which Master's Fields Depend Most on International Students?



International share of master's degrees by field, 2025; fields with 30+ graduates. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

13%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **29th** of 51

36%
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **35th** of 51

40%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **37th** of 47

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: North Dakota first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

Highest international share among STEM master's fields. International students earned 49% of the master's degrees in engineering, against 49% for the U.S.

Table 2 How International Is Each STEM Field?

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	7.1% / 8.6%	**40% / 65%**	– / 56%
Engineering	3.6% / 7.2%	**49% / 49%**	69% / 55%
Engineering technology	0.0% / 4.5%	**– / 54%**	– / 42%
Math & statistics	2.9% / 17%	**– / 55%**	– / 53%
Physical sciences	4.7% / 6.0%	**– / 33%**	50% / 38%
Biological sciences	4.4% / 3.4%	**37% / 23%**	28% / 23%
Natural resources	2.0% / 2.0%	**– / 17%**	– / 27%
Architecture	4.1% / 7.3%	**1.6% / 29%**	– / 55%

International share in North Dakota / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

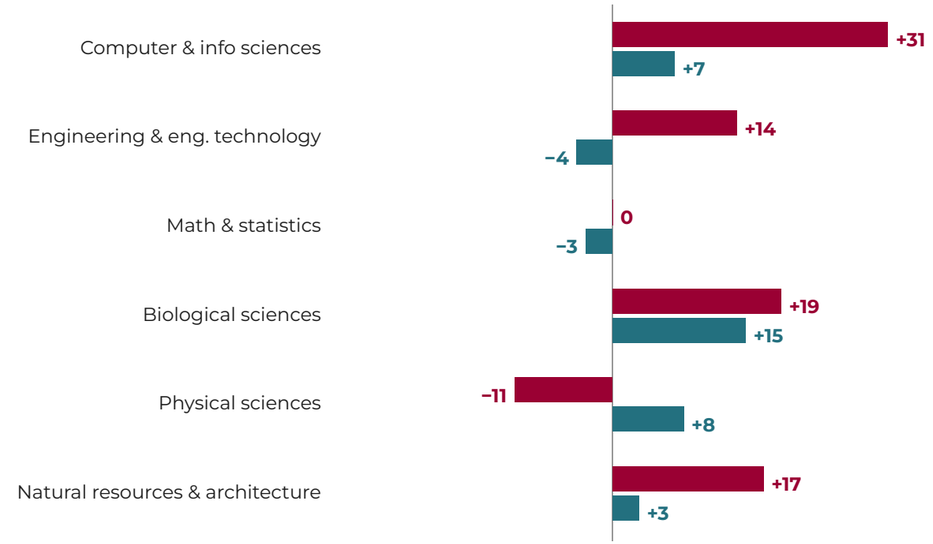
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How Has North Dakota's STEM Master's Output Grown?

Each pair of bars is the change in the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in North Dakota between 2015 and 2025 in one field: to domestic students (U.S. citizens and permanent residents) and to international students. Bars to the left of the axis are declines.

STEM master's degrees. The state awarded 340 in 2025 and 244 in 2015, a change of +26 for international students and +70 for domestic students.

Figure 6 Where Did the STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

122
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · **42nd** of 51

18%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **30th** of 51

0.1%
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025
42nd of 51

2.8
STEM master's per STEM research doctorate, 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **47th** of 51

The table gives the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in North Dakota in each field in 2015 and 2025, the change between the two years, the number awarded to international students in 2025, and international students' share of the field's degrees in each year.

STEM share of master's degrees. The share was 18% in 2025, against 23% for the U.S., 30th among the states, up 1.4 points from 17% in 2024 and up 4.0 points since 2015, when it was 14%.

Table 3 How Many STEM Master's Degrees Does Each Field Award?

Field	2015	2025	Change	International 2025	Int. share 2015	Int. share 2025
Computer & info sciences	17	**55**	–	22	–	40%
Engineering & eng. technology	102	**112**	+9.8%	55	58%	49%
Math & statistics	16	**13**	–	8	–	–
Biological sciences	29	**63**	–	23	–	37%
Physical sciences	22	**19**	–	9	–	–
Natural resources & architecture	58	**78**	+34%	5	3.4%	6.4%

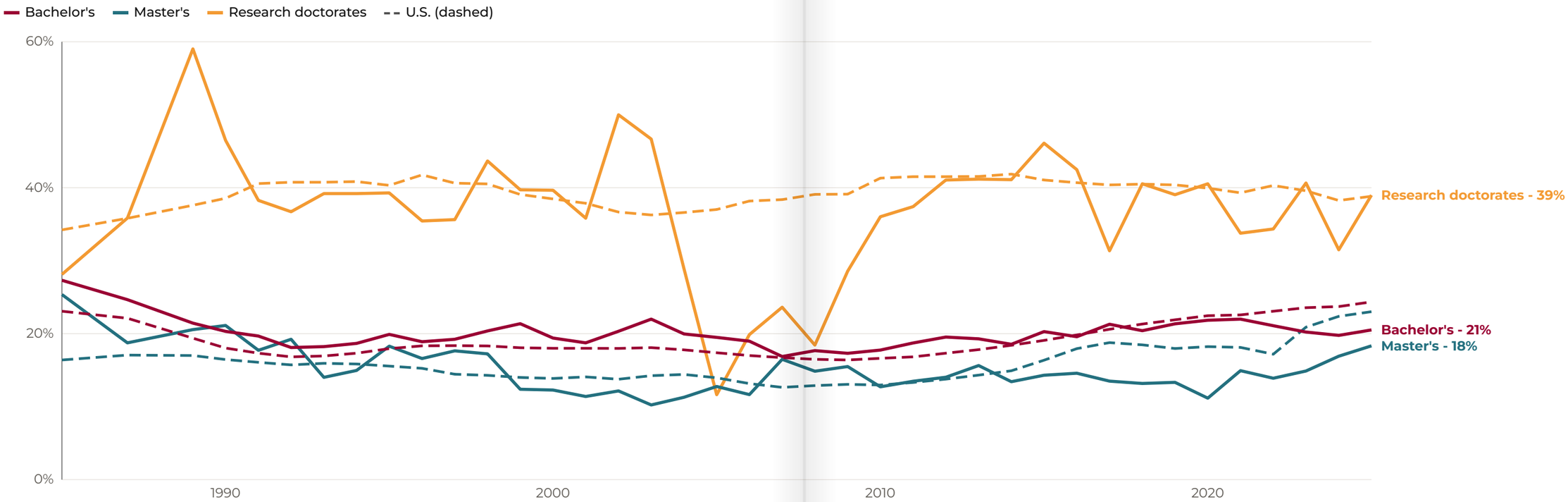
STEM master's degrees awarded in North Dakota, all students and international students, 2015 and 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

North Dakota ranks 37th of 51 on the STEM share of bachelor's, at 21% in 2025 against 24% for the U.S.

Figure 7 How Much of North Dakota's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 21% of North Dakota's bachelor's degrees, 18% of its master's and 39% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

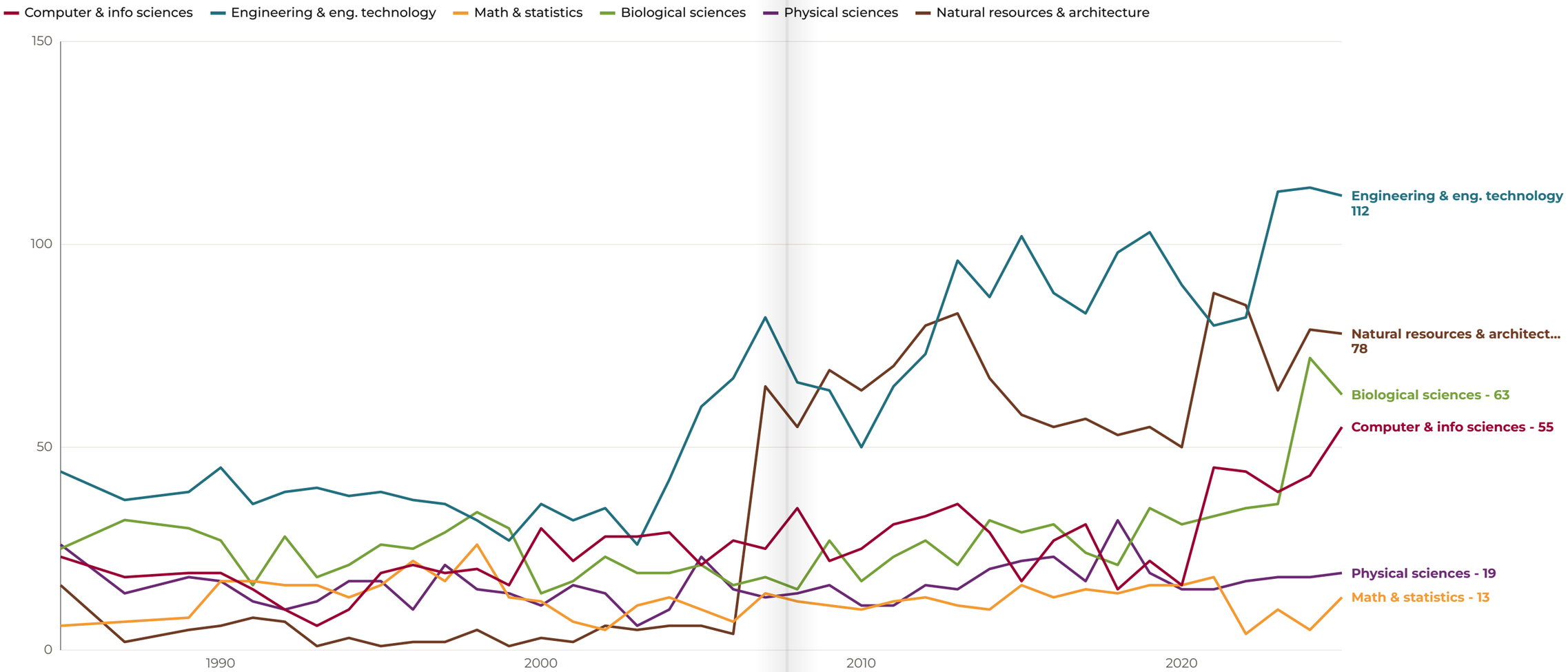
The STEM share of master's degrees is up 4.0 points since 2015, and the state ranks 30th of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 37th of 51.

21%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · **37th** of 51 · +0.2 pp since 2015

18%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **30th** of 51 · +4.0 pp since 2015

39%
STEM share of research doctorates, 2025
U.S. **39%** · **33rd** of 51 · −7.1 pp since 2015

Figure 8 Which STEM Fields Produce North Dakota's Master's Degrees?



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Engineering & eng. technology produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 112, followed by natural resources & architecture (78) and biological sciences (63). Master's degrees in engineering & eng. technology are up 10% since 2015.

International students earned 122 of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 0.1% of the national total (42nd of 51).

122

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **42nd** of 51 · +27% since 2015

0.1%

Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

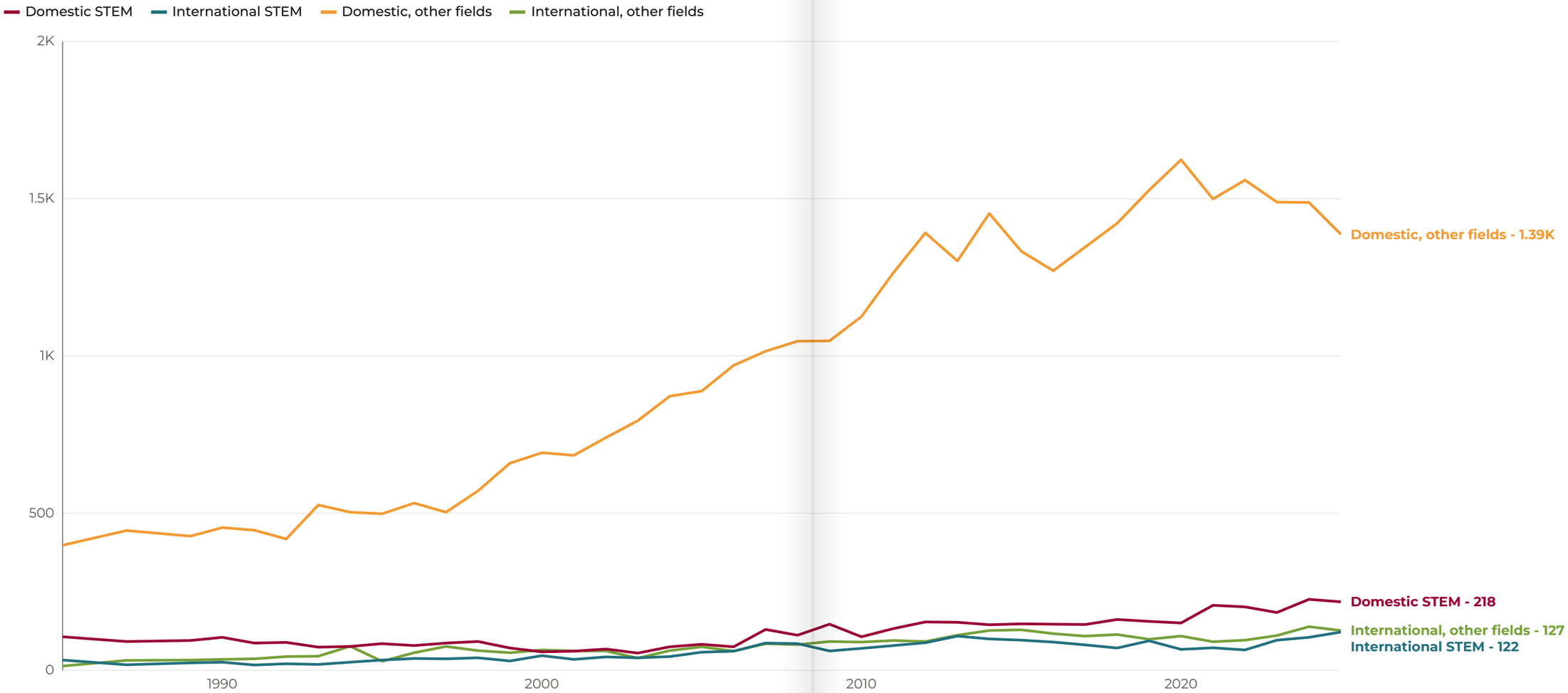
42nd of 51 · −0.1 pp since 2015

40%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

U.S. **65%** · **37th** of 47 · −50.3 pp since 2017

Figure 9 Who Earns North Dakota's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, 26 more STEM master's degrees went to international students and 70 more to domestic students.

International students earn 36% of North Dakota's STEM master's but 8.4% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).

13%

Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **29th** of 51 · +0.2 pp since 2015

36%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **35th** of 51 · −3.5 pp since 2015

2.8

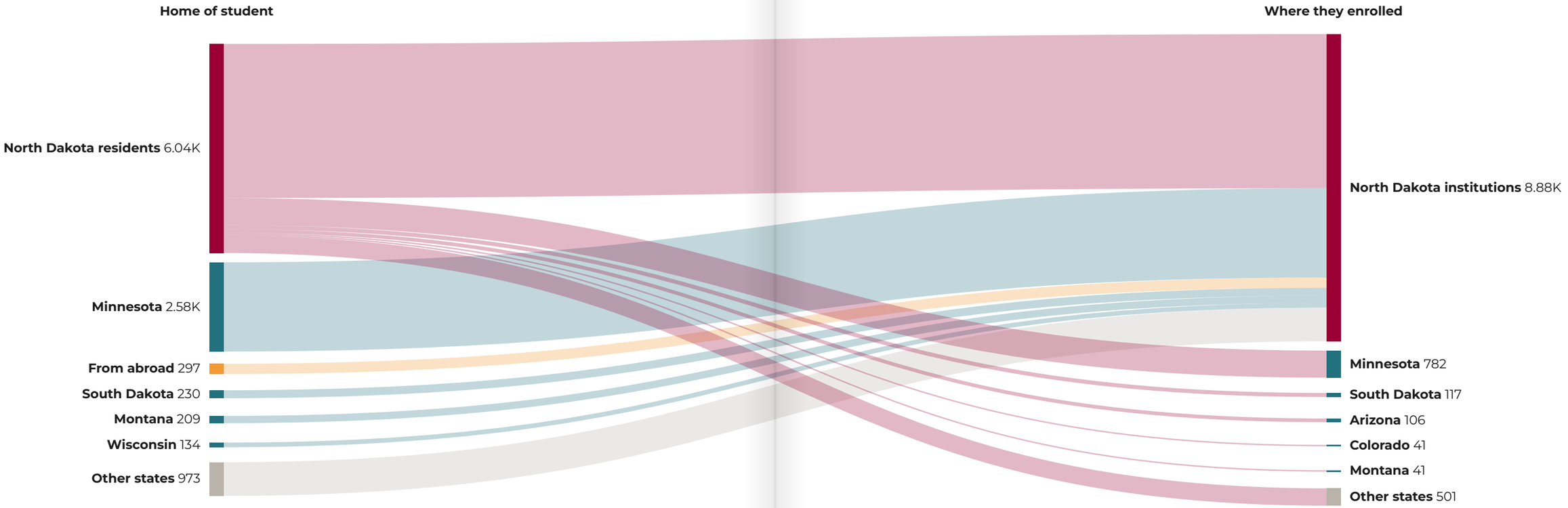
STEM master's per STEM research doctorate (IPEDS), 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **47th** of 51 · 0.0 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

North Dakota ranks 47th of 51 on the share of first-time students who are in-state residents, at 50% in 2024.

Figure 10 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest sources and destinations (more when states tie at the printed figure), the rest grouped; ties are ordered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

4.45K residents stayed in North Dakota for college in fall 2024; 4.13K students arrived from other states and 297 from abroad, while 1.59K residents left.

Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 50% of the state's first-time students are residents.

50%

First-time students from in state, 2024

47th of 51 · −1.0 pp since 2016

3.3%

First-time students from abroad, 2024

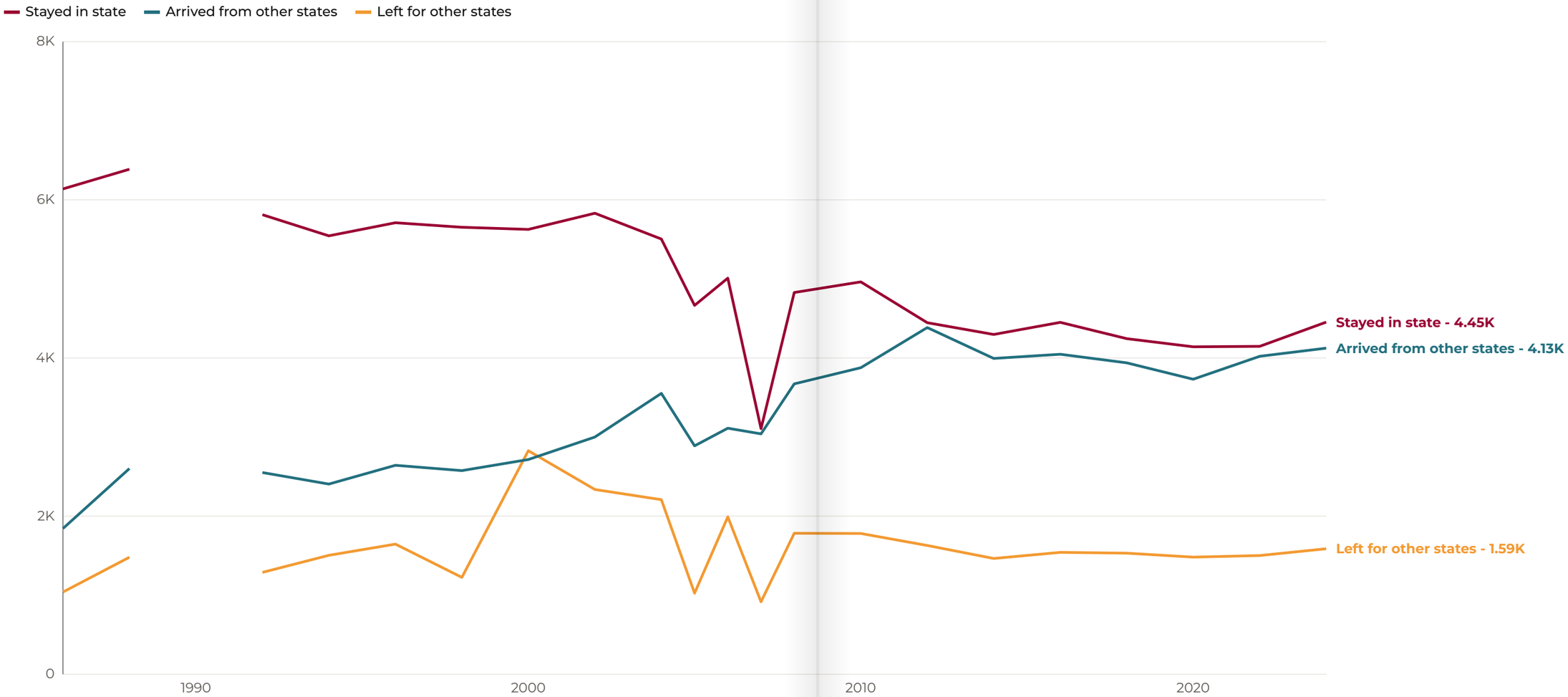
U.S. **3.1%** · **17th** of 51 · +1.0 pp since 2016

+42

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

5th of 51 · +0.2 since 2016

Figure 11 How Have the Flows Changed?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is roughly flat, arrivals from other states are roughly flat, and residents leaving are up 3%.

Net migration was +42 per 100 resident first-time students (5th of 51). The top destination for residents who left was Minnesota (782).

Figure 12

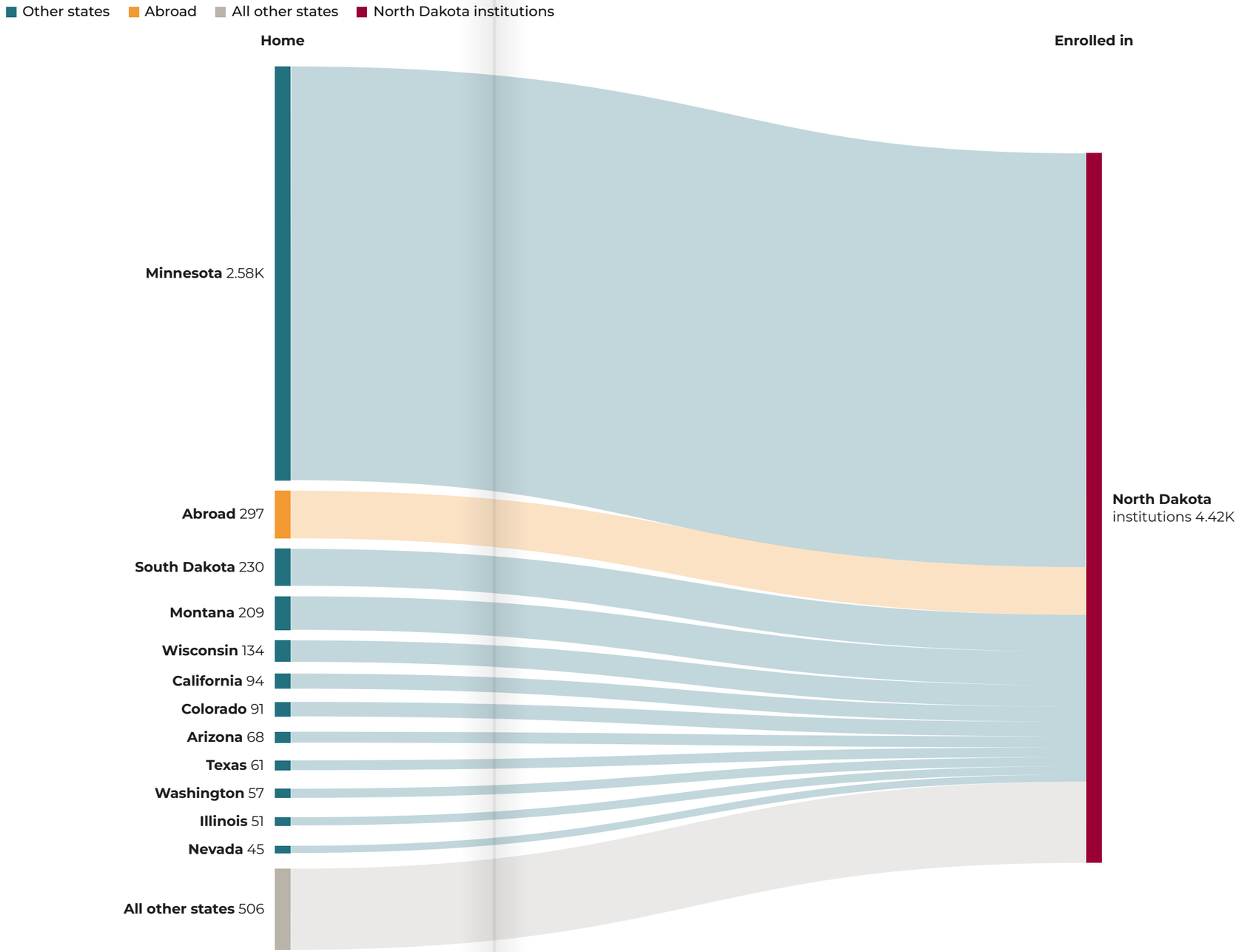
Where Do North Dakota's Newcomers Come From?

The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at North Dakota's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

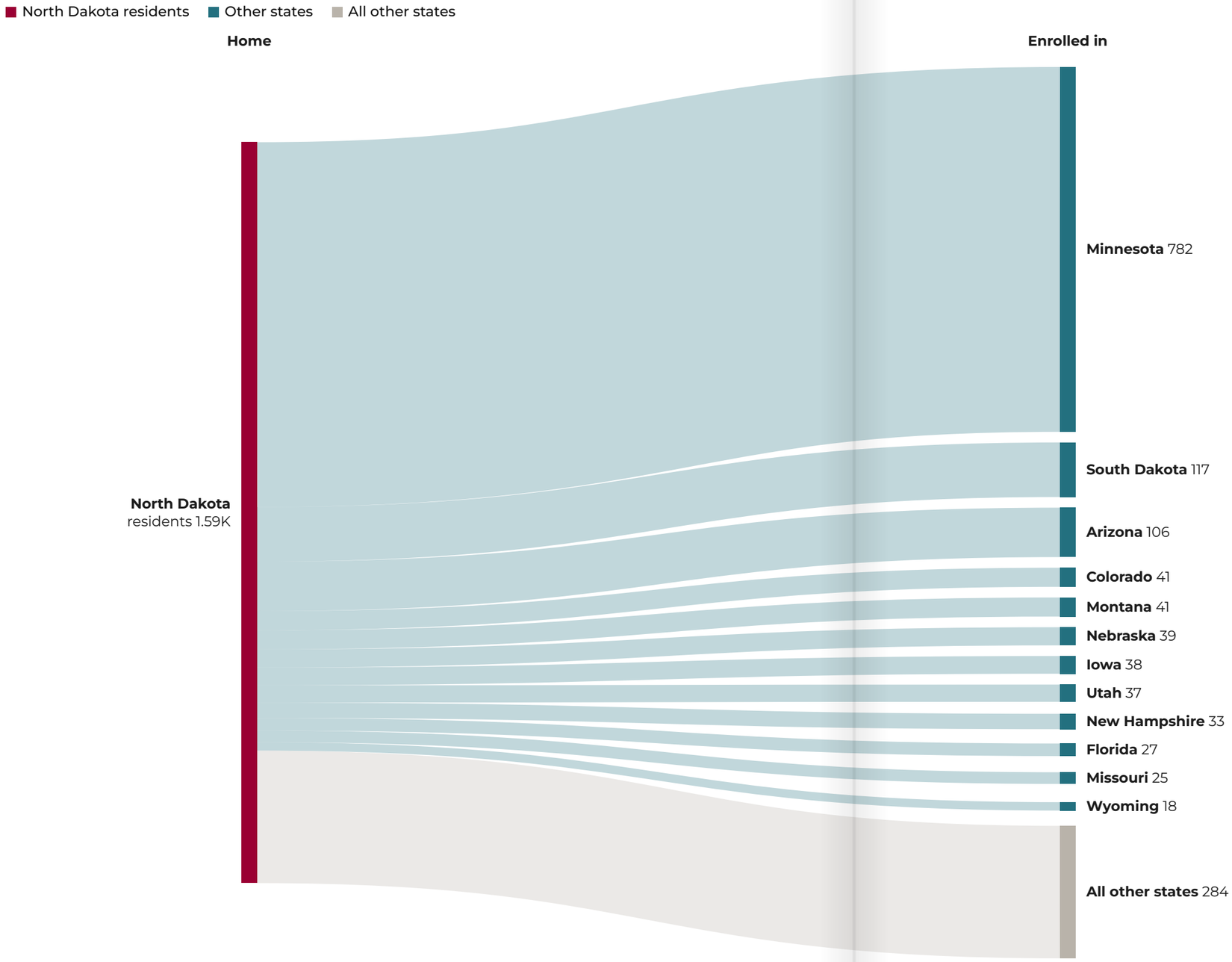
4.42K
First-time students from other states and abroad, fall 2024
Abroad **297**

3.3%
First-time students from abroad, 2024
U.S. **3.1%** · **17th** of 51 · +1.0 pp since 2016

50%
First-time students from in state, 2024
47th of 51 · −1.0 pp since 2016



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows (more when states tie at the printed figure), ordered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows (more when states tie at the printed figure), ordered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Figure 13

Where Do North Dakota's Residents Go When They Leave?

The bands show where North Dakota residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

Residents leaving for other states. The number was 1.59K in fall 2024, up 5.8% from 1.5K in fall 2022 and up 3.0% since fall 2016, when it was 1.54K.

1.59K
Residents who started college in another state, fall 2024
Arrived from other states **4.13K** · **4.42K** with abroad

+42
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024
5th of 51 · +0.2 since 2016

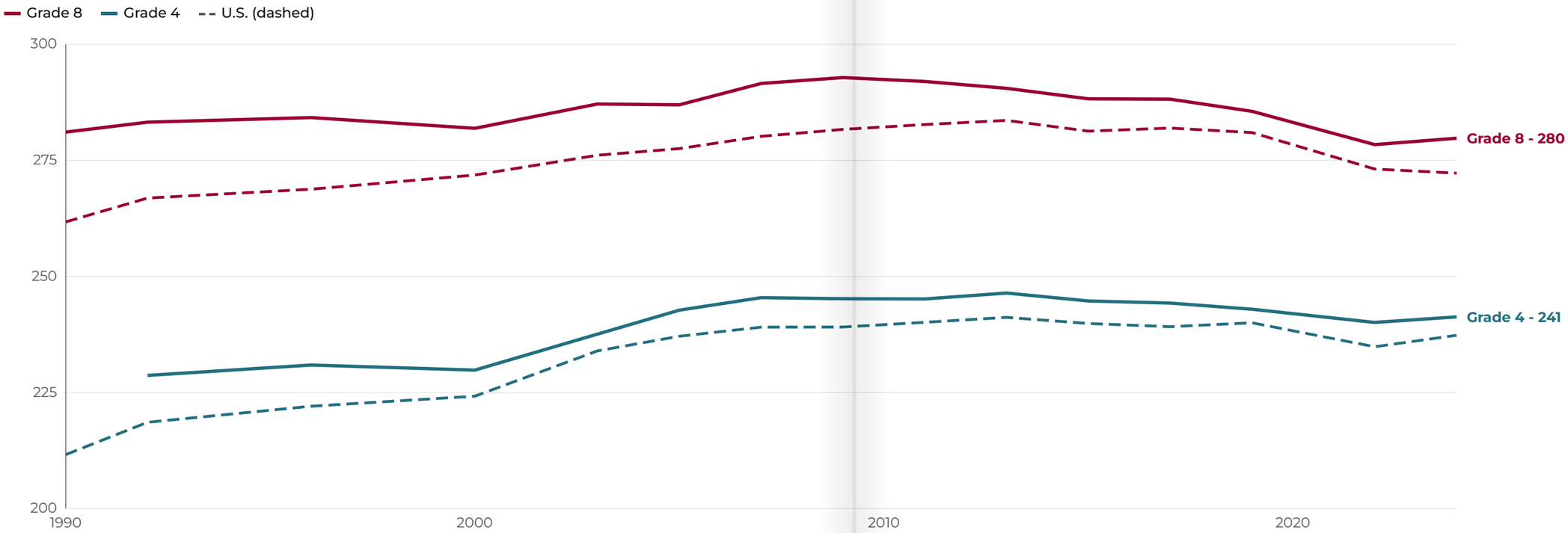
782
Went to Minnesota
The largest destination

SECTION 4

K-12 Preparation

North Dakota ranks 8th of 51 on the average grade 8 mathematics score, at 280 in 2024 against 272 for the U.S.

Figure 14 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are North Dakota's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, National Assessment of Educational Progress.

The talent pipeline starts in school. North Dakota's eighth graders averaged 280 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 8th of 51 among the states.

29% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.

280

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **8th** of 51 · −8.5 since 2015

29%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **21st** of 51 · −9.7 pp since 2015

257

Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

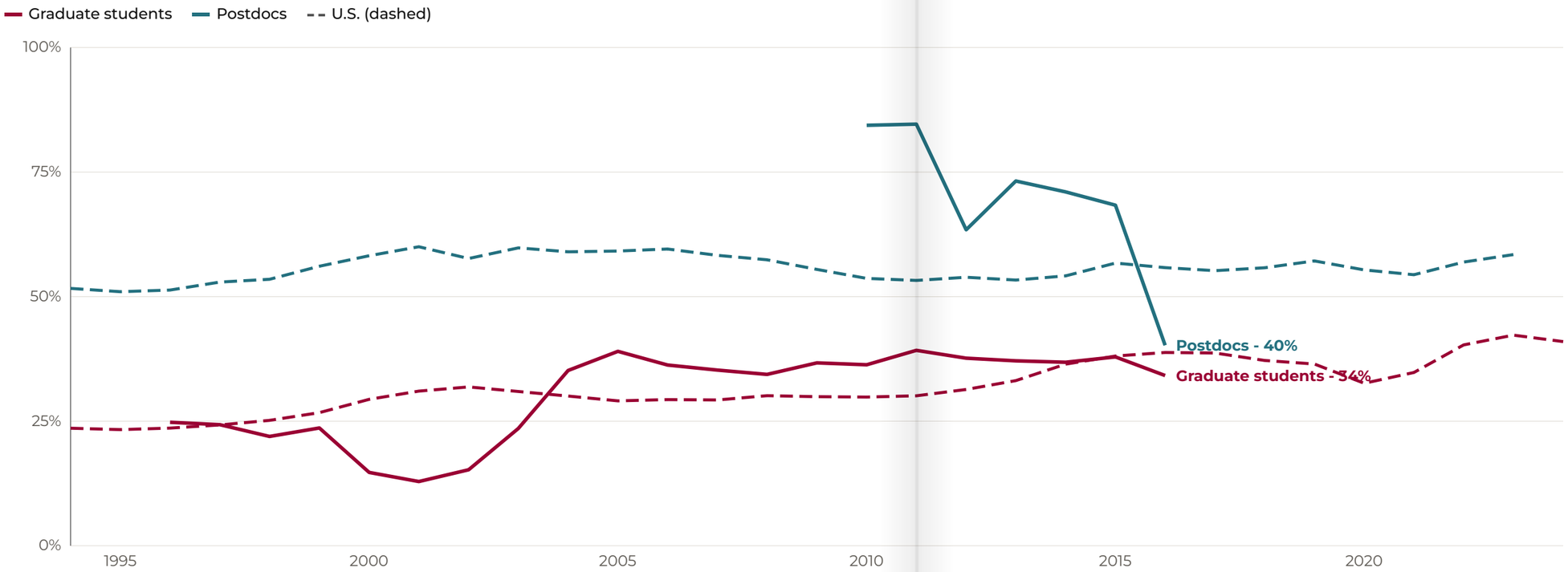
U.S. **257** · **24th** of 51 · −9.6 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

North Dakota ranks 44th of 51 on the temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs, at 40% in 2016 against 56% for the U.S.

Figure 15 How Many of North Dakota's Science and Engineering Graduate Students Hold Temporary Visas?



Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's state; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 34% of North Dakota's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 26th of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 40% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 209 research doctorates in 2025, 0.4% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

34%
S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016
U.S. **39%** · **26th** of 51 · −3.7 pp since 2015

40%
S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016
U.S. **56%** · **44th** of 51 · −28.1 pp since 2015

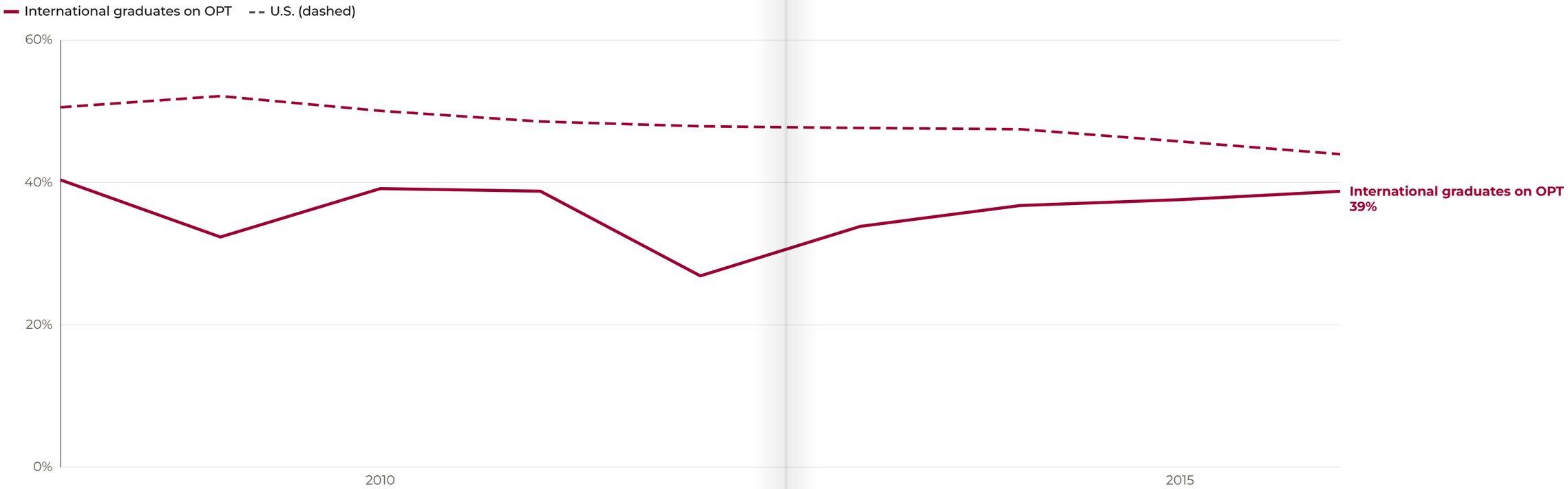
209
Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025
U.S. **59K** · **43rd** of 51 · +19% since 2015

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

North Dakota ranks 20th of 51 on the share of international graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied, at 39% in 2016 against 44% for the U.S.

Figure 16 How Many of North Dakota's Graduates Go On to Work in the State?



Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or participating states dashed.

North Dakota's institutions do not take part in the Census Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes program, so in-state employment of its graduates is not published.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 39% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). That is the last year the released records cover, before most of the growth in international STEM master's degrees since 2015. Through migration between states, the state gained 1.7 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).

39%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **20th** of 51 · +1.2 pp since 2015

+1.7

Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

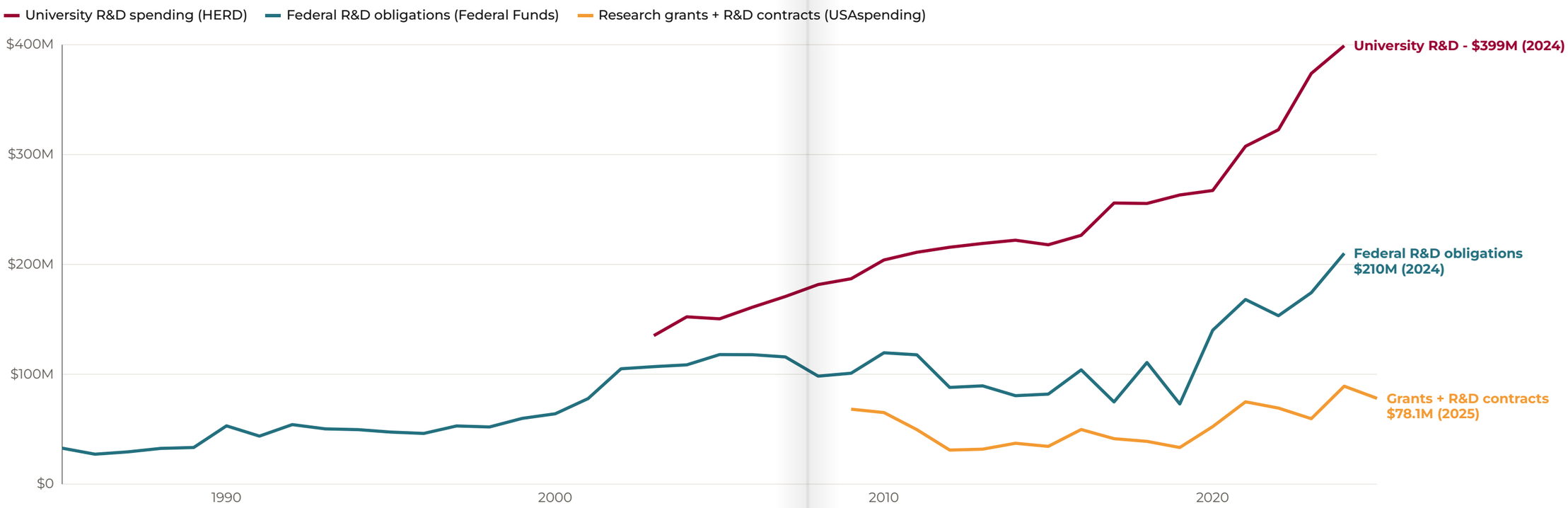
23rd of 51 · −1.2 since 2015

SECTION 7

Research Funding

North Dakota ranks 51st of 51 on the federally funded share of university R&D, at 36% in 2024 against 55% for the U.S.

Figure 17 How Much Research Money Flows Into North Dakota?



Nominal dollars (not adjusted for inflation), fiscal years; a line ending before the others is labeled with its last year. University R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Development Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey). Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage widens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D contracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

North Dakota's universities spent $399M on research and development in FY2024, 43rd of 51 among the states; 36% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $210M for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

$399M

University R&D spending, 2024

U.S. **$118B** · **43rd** of 51 · +83% since 2015

36%

Federal share of university R&D, 2024

U.S. **55%** · **51st** of 51 · +2.2 pp since 2015

$210M

Federal R&D obligations, 2024

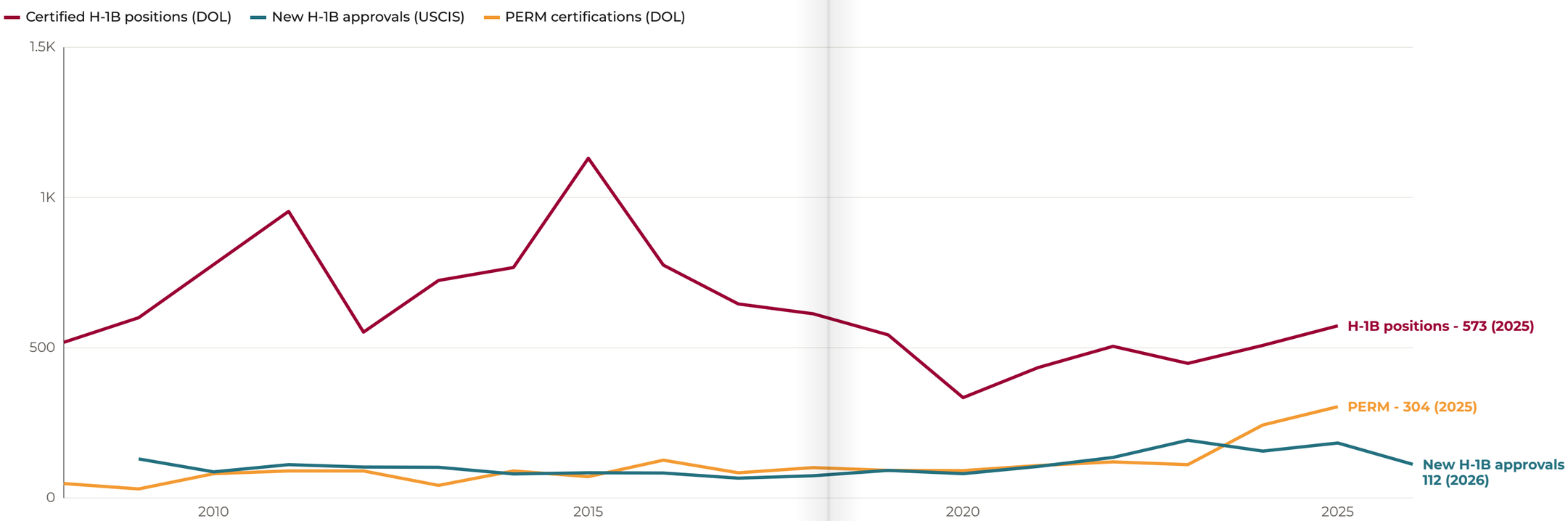
U.S. **$193B** · **48th** of 51 · 2.56× since 2015

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

North Dakota ranks 46th of 51 on certified H-1B positions, by worksite, at 573 in 2025 against 914K for the U.S.

Figure 18 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does North Dakota Generate?



Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 573 H-1B positions at North Dakota worksites in FY2025, 46th of 51 among the states. A labor condition application comes before the petition and covers renewals and job changes as well as new hires, by the worksite's state, so it runs well above approvals. USCIS approved 112 new H-1B petitions in FY2026 and 182 continuing ones, counted by the employer's address.

DOL certified 304 PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 12% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

573

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **46th** of 51 · −49% since 2015

304

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

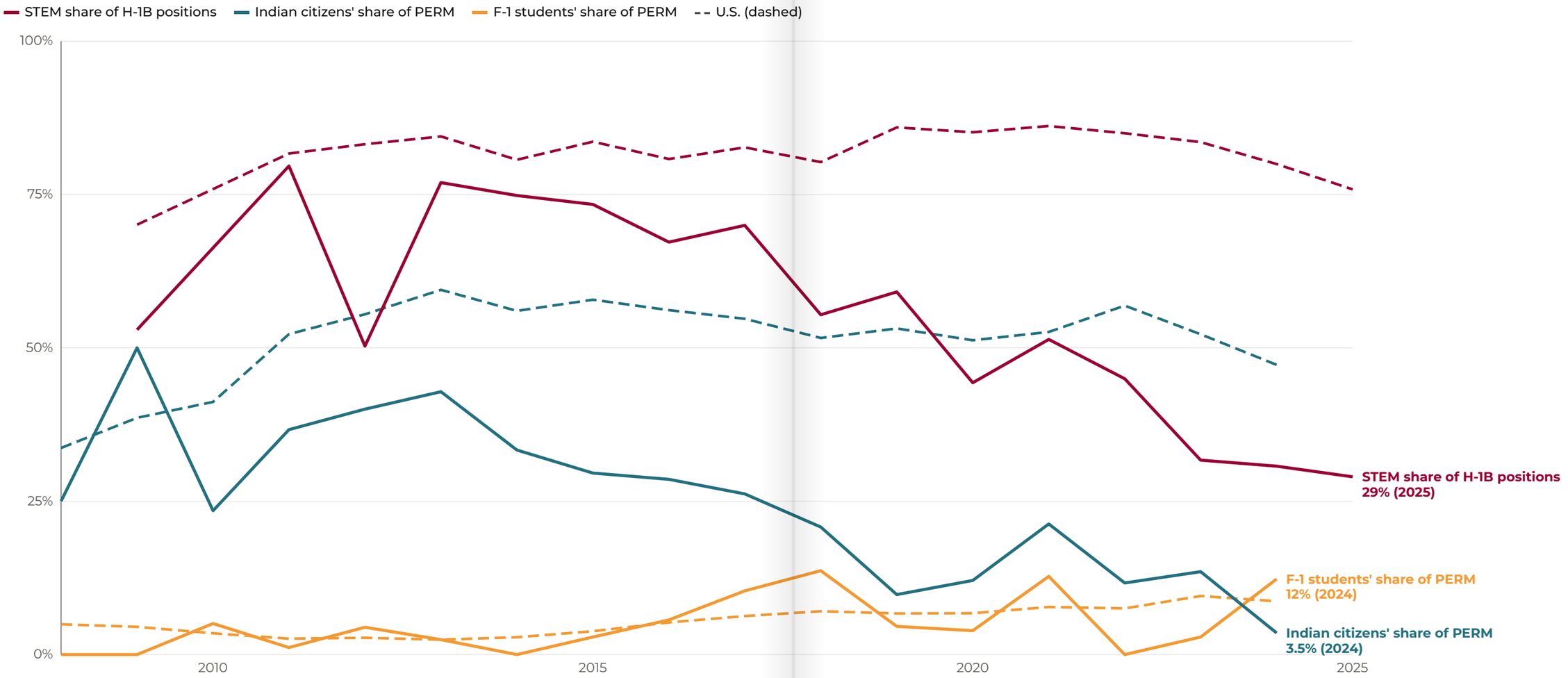
U.S. **138K** · **40th** of 51 · 4.28× since 2015

12%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **15th** of 51 · +9.5 pp since 2015

Figure 19 Who Holds North Dakota's Skilled-Visa Jobs?



State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

29% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 3.5% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

29%

STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025

U.S. **76%** · **46th** of 51 · −44.4 pp since 2015

3.5%

PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024

U.S. **47%** · **49th** of 51 · −26.1 pp since 2015

$70.7K

Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025

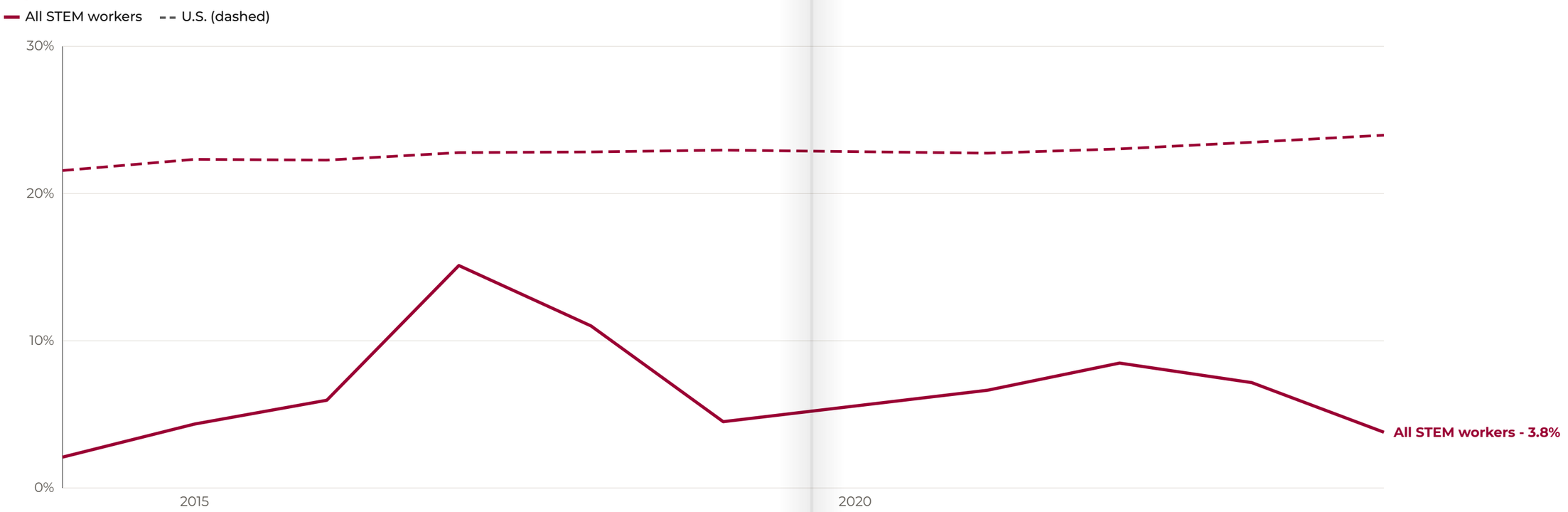
U.S. **$119K** · **50th** of 51 · +6.8% since 2015

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

North Dakota ranks 49th of 51 on the foreign-born share of STEM workers, at 3.8% in 2024 against 24% for the U.S.

Figure 20 How Much of North Dakota's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resting on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey.

In 2024, 3.8% of the people working in STEM occupations in North Dakota were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 49th of 51).

3.8%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **49th** of 51 · −0.6 pp since 2015

2.3%

Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

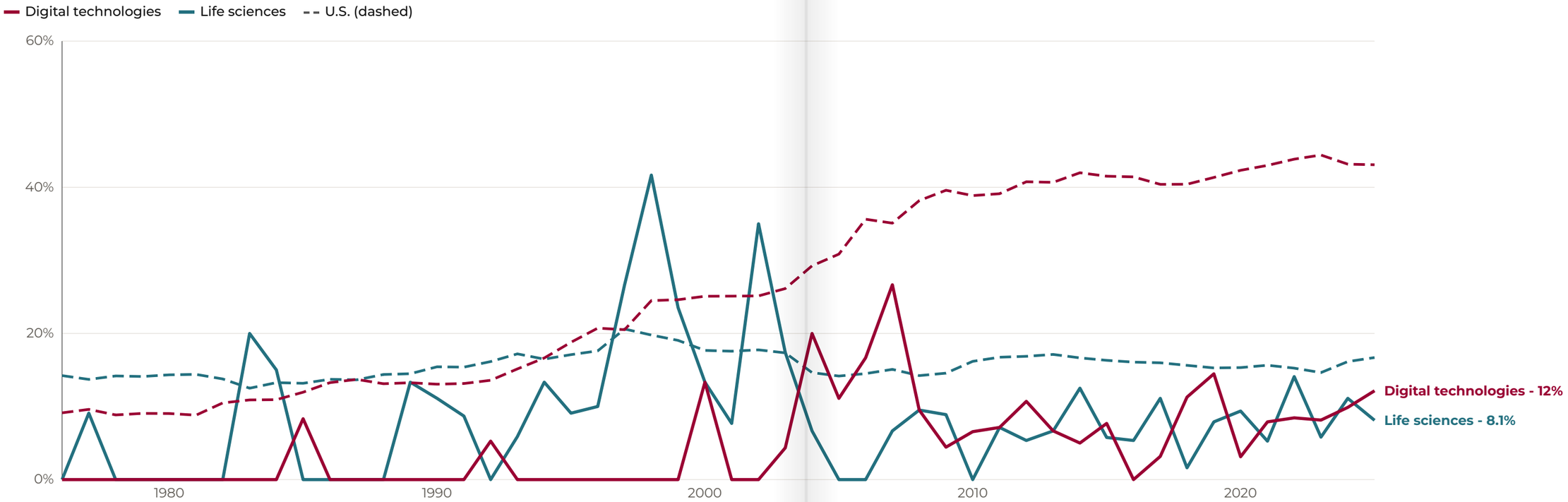
U.S. **11%** · **49th** of 51 · −1.4 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

North Dakota ranks 48th of 51 on the share of the state's patents in life sciences, at 8.1% in 2025 against 17% for the U.S.

Figure 21 What Kinds of Technology Does North Dakota Patent?



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

Organizations and people in North Dakota were granted 74 U.S. patents in 2025, 0.1% of all patents with a U.S. owner (46th of 51).

12% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 8.1% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).

74

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **46th** of 51 · +47% since 2015

12%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **38th** of 51 · +4.5 pp since 2015

8.1%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

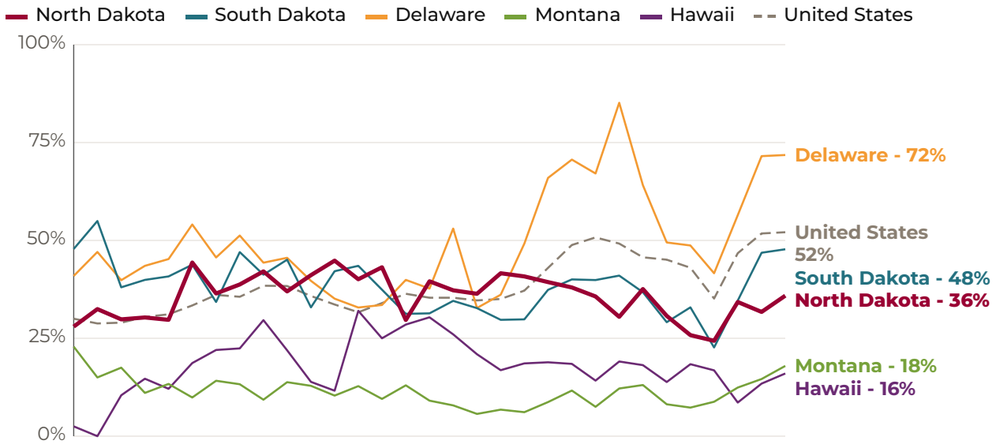
U.S. **17%** · **48th** of 51 · +2.3 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

The four states closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally (a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size), are South Dakota, Delaware, Montana, and Hawaii. North Dakota ranks 3rd of the five on the international share of STEM master's; Delaware is the most dependent at 72%.

Figure 22 How Dependent Are North Dakota and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?



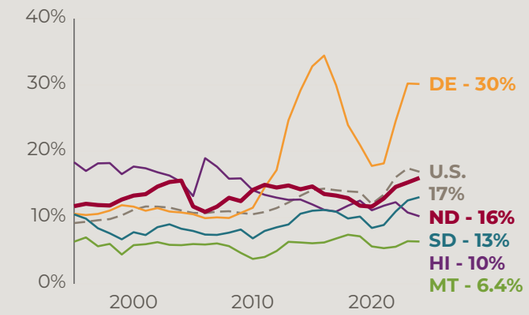
Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Table 4 How Does North Dakota Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	ND	SD	DE	MT	HI	U.S.
Students enrolled, 2024	**53.5K**	54.2K	57.8K	48.4K	61.4K	19.7M
Graduate share of students, 2024	**15%**	17%	18%	12%	12%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025	**21%**	26%	22%	32%	20%	24%
STEM share of master's, 2025	**18%**	27%	38%	22%	17%	23%
International STEM master's, 2025	**122**	277	1.03K	56	40	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025	**0.1%**	0.2%	0.9%	0.0%	0.0%	–
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025	**36%**	48%	72%	18%	16%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates, 2025	**57%**	40%	52%	12%	35%	43%
Int. share of grad students, 2024	**16%**	13%	30%	6.4%	10%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment, 2024	**2.7%**	3.4%	3.5%	1.1%	6.2%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024	**60%**	58%	72%	52%	56%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023	**$9.87K**	$9.25K	$11.8K	$7.93K	$10.4K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student, 2024	**$11.9K**	$9.61K	$8.9K	$9.29K	$16.9K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary, 2024	**$82.6K**	$79.3K	$123K	$82K	$110K	$106K
First-time students from in state, 2024	**50%**	58%	58%	58%	73%	–
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024	**+42**	+22	+7	+21	−21	–

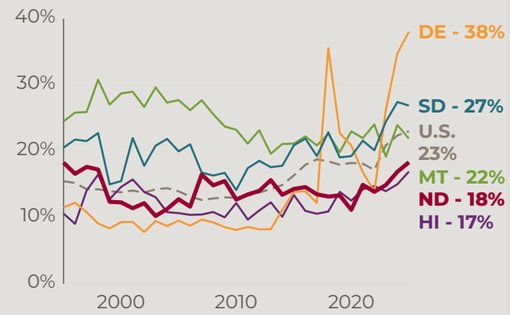
Latest year for each measure, given after its name. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 23 Int. share of grad students



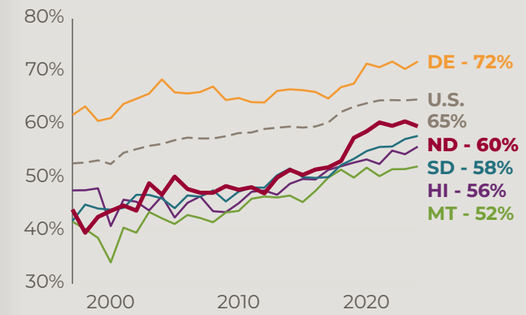
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 STEM share of master's



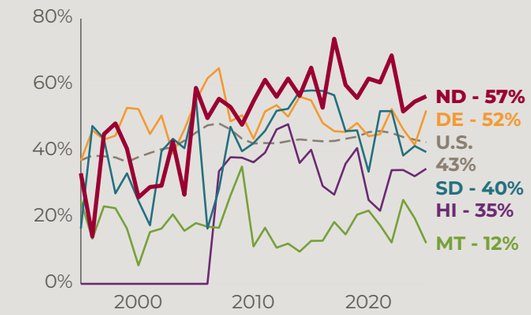
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 25 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 26 Int. share of STEM doctorates

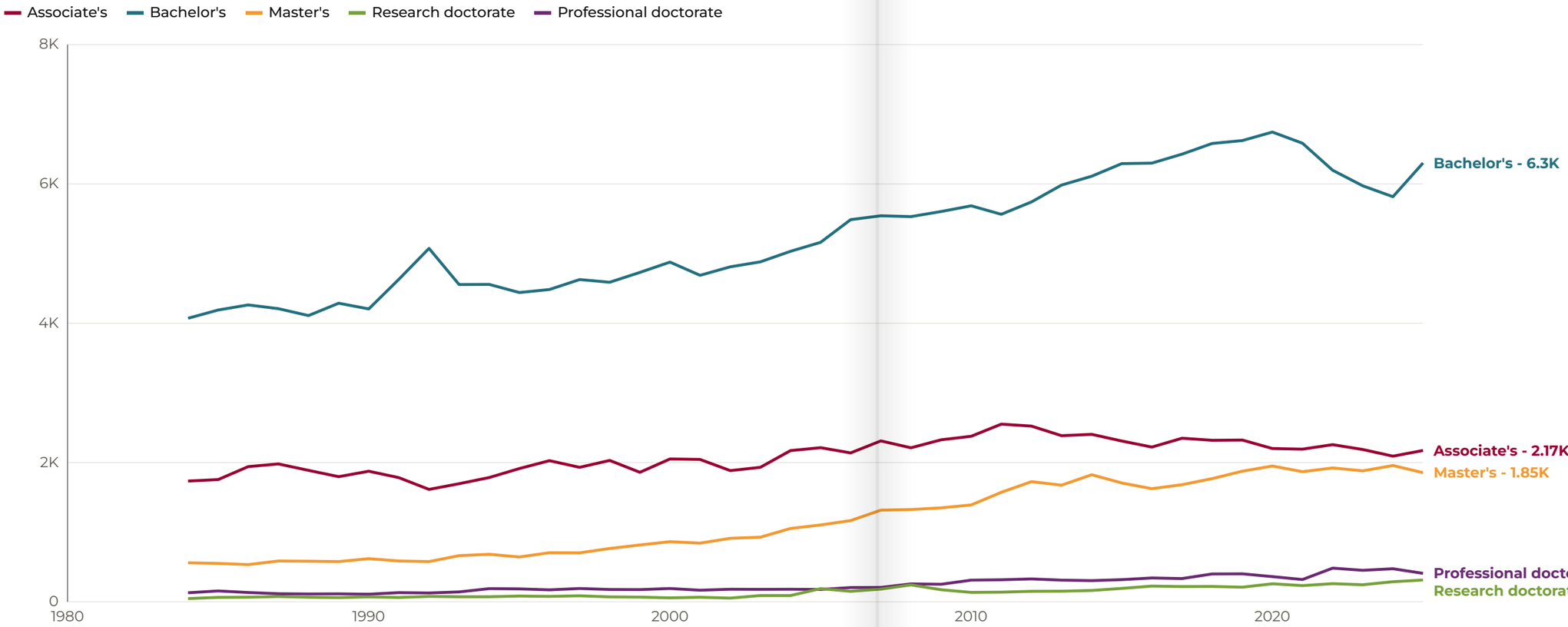


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

Fields of Study

Figure 27 How Many Degrees Does North Dakota Award?



Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

In 2025, North Dakota's institutions awarded 2.17K associate's degrees, 6.3K bachelor's degrees, 1.85K master's degrees, 313 research doctorate degrees, 409 professional doctorate degrees.

Since 2015: associate's down 6%; bachelor's roughly flat; master's up 9%; research doctorate up 62%; professional doctorate up 29%. The state awards 13.9 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

Figure 28 What Do North Dakota's Bachelor's Graduates Study?



Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

North Dakota's largest bachelor's fields are business (19%; U.S. 19%), health professions (13%; U.S. 13%), education (9.2%; U.S. 4.3%).

Relative to the nation, North Dakota's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in transportation (16.99× the U.S. share), family & consumer sci. (2.88× the U.S. share), agriculture (2.44× the U.S. share).

3.1%

Bachelor's in computer science, 2025

U.S. **6.9%** · **48th** of 51 · +1.2 pp since 2015

9.2%

Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025

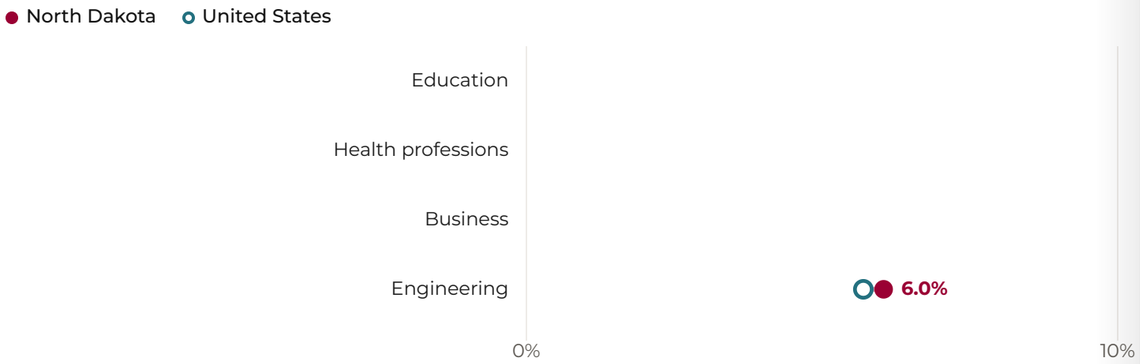
U.S. **6.8%** · **6th** of 51 · −0.3 pp since 2015

19%

Bachelor's in business, 2025

U.S. **19%** · **28th** of 51 · +1.1 pp since 2015

Figure 29 What Do North Dakota's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

North Dakota's largest master's fields are education (25%; U.S. 15%), health professions (18%; U.S. 15%), business (17%; U.S. 21%).

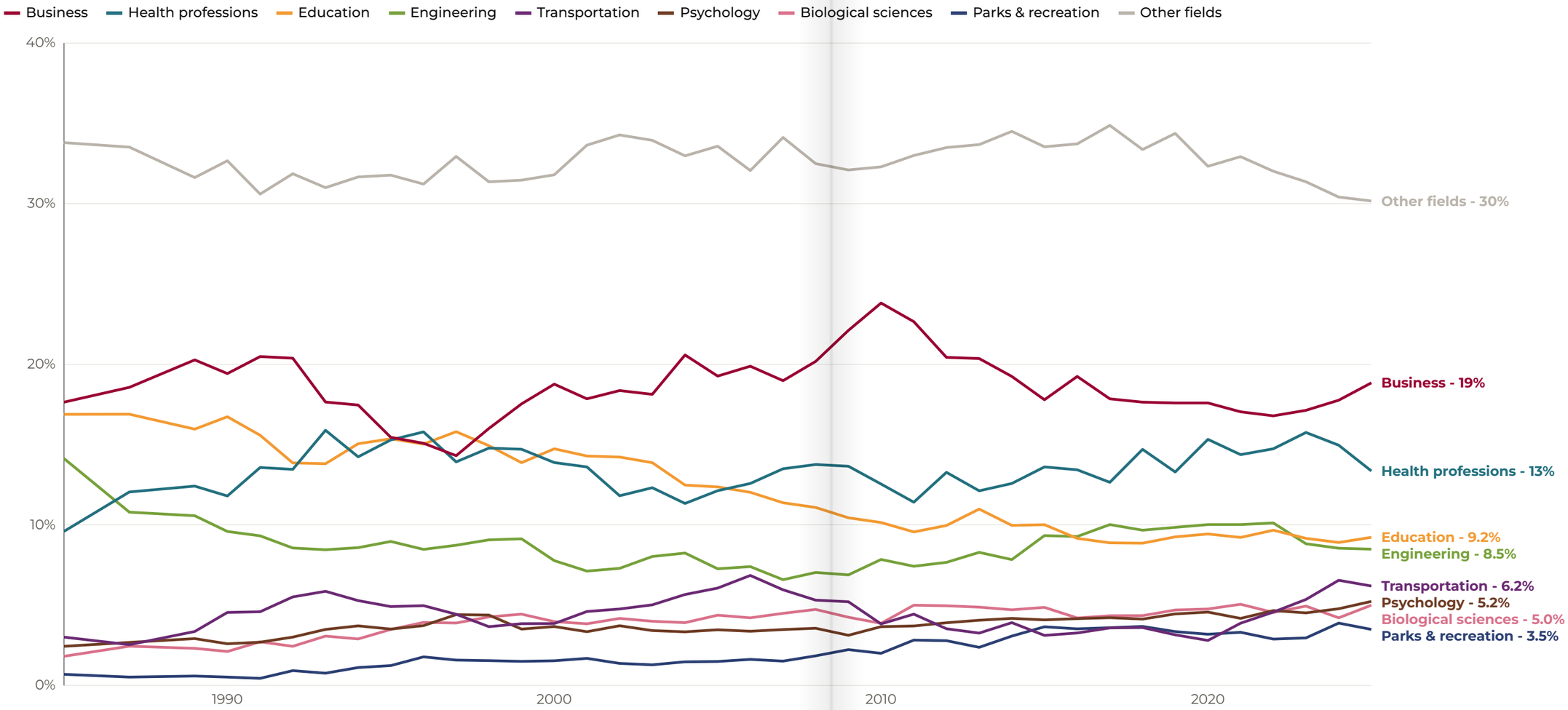
International students earn 13% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 18% of them.

18%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **30th** of 51 · +4.0 pp since 2015

13%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **29th** of 51 · +0.2 pp since 2015

40%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **37th** of 47 · −50.3 pp since 2017

Figure 30 How Has North Dakota's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, transportation has gained the most ground, 3.1 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while engineering lost the most (0.8 points).

The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

SECTION 12 · FIELDS OF STUDY

Where Is North Dakota Most Specialized?

The location quotient divides a field's share of North Dakota's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the 10 fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

Highest location quotients. Transportation (16.99, with 6.2% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.4% for the U.S.), family & consumer sci. (2.88, with 2.4% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.8% for the U.S.), and agriculture (2.44, with 2.5% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 1.0% for the U.S.) had the highest quotients.

Table 5 Where Is North Dakota Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Transportation	**16.99**	6.2%	0.4%	390
Family & consumer sci.	**2.88**	2.4%	0.8%	149
Agriculture	**2.44**	2.5%	1.0%	158
Education	**2.13**	9.2%	4.3%	581
Liberal arts	**1.82**	3.3%	1.8%	208
Public administration	**1.51**	2.2%	1.5%	140
Engineering	**1.45**	8.5%	5.9%	535
Parks & recreation	**1.33**	3.5%	2.6%	220
Security & protective	**1.20**	3.1%	2.6%	193
Health professions	**1.07**	13%	13%	842

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

21%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · **37th** of 51

3.1%
Bachelor's in computer science, 2025
U.S. **6.9%** · **48th** of 51

9.2%
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025
U.S. **6.8%** · **6th** of 51

Engineering & eng. technology. The share was 9.2% in 2025, against 6.8% for the U.S., 6th among the states, down 0.3 points from 9.5% in 2024 and down 0.3 points since 2015, when it was 9.5%.

Health professions. The share was 13% in 2025, against 12% for the U.S., 17th among the states, down 1.6 points from 15% in 2024 and down 0.2 points since 2015, when it was 14%.

Table 6 North Dakota at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
STEM share of bachelor's	20%	20% 2024	**21% 2025**	+0.2 pp	24%	37th
Bachelor's in computer science	1.9%	2.6% 2024	**3.1% 2025**	+1.2 pp	6.9%	48th
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	9.5%	9.5% 2024	**9.2% 2025**	−0.3 pp	6.8%	6th
Bachelor's in business	18%	18% 2024	**19% 2025**	+1.1 pp	19%	28th

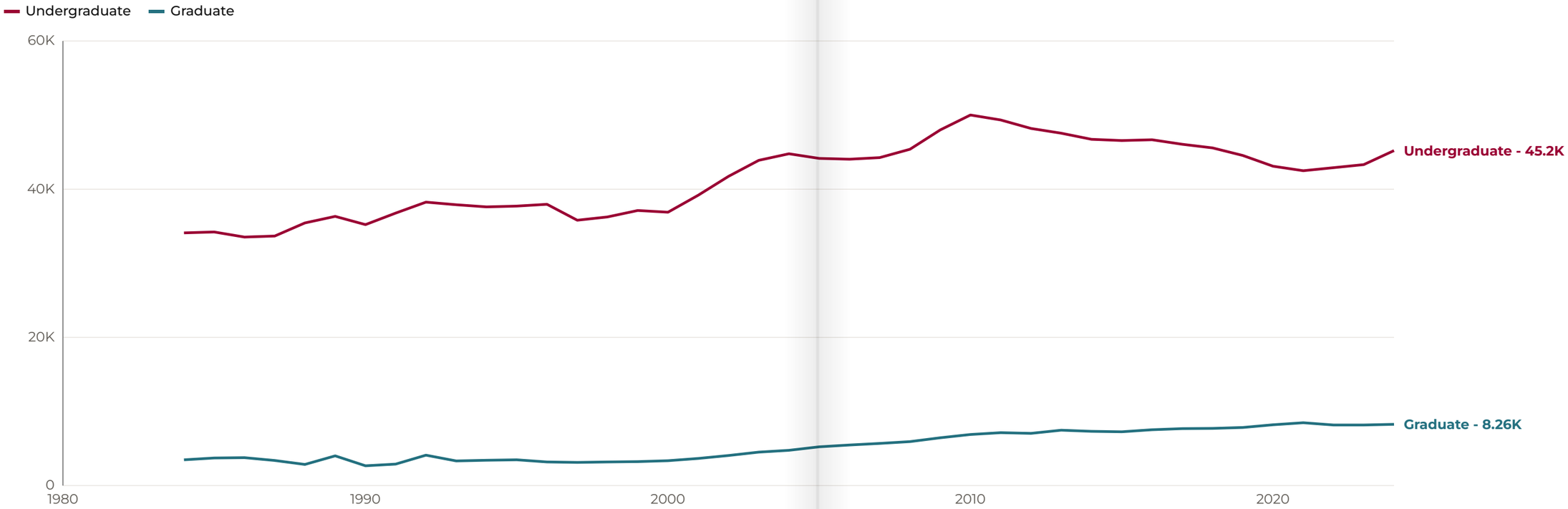
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 13

Students and Money

North Dakota ranks 47th of 51 on fall enrollment, at 53.5K in 2024 against 19.7M for the U.S.

Figure 31 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, North Dakota enrolled 45.2K undergraduates and 8.26K graduate students, 53.5K in all (47th of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is down 3% since 2015 and graduate enrollment up 14% since 2015. Graduate students are 15% of all students (U.S. 17%).

53.5K

Students enrolled, 2024

U.S. **19.7M** · **47th** of 51 · −0.7% since 2015

15%

Graduate share of students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **27th** of 51 · +2.0 pp since 2015

36%

Students attending part-time, 2024

U.S. **39%** · **35th** of 51 · +5.6 pp since 2015

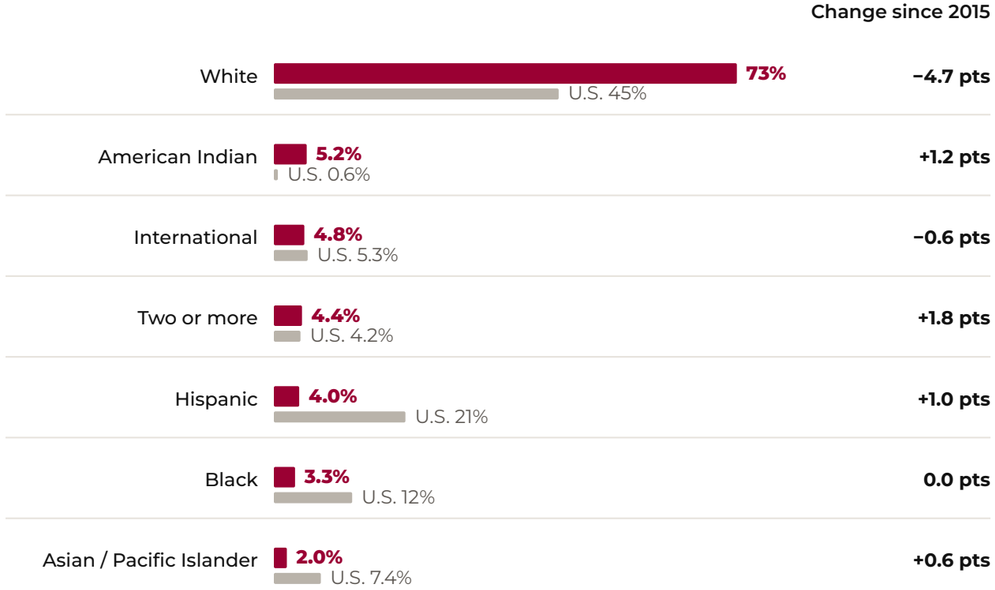
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

Who Enrolls in North Dakota, and Where?

In fall 2024, White students were the largest group at North Dakota's degree-granting institutions, **73%** of enrollment against 45% nationally, down 4.7 points since 2015.

American Indian students were **5.2%** (U.S. 0.6%), up 1.2 points since 2015, and International students were **4.8%** (U.S. 5.3%), down 0.6 points since 2015.

Figure 32 Who Enrolls in North Dakota?



Share of fall 2024 headcount enrollment by race and ethnicity; students of unknown race are left out of the chart. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

73%
White students
U.S. **45%** · −4.7 pp since 2015

5.2%
American Indian students
U.S. **0.6%** · +1.2 pp since 2015

73%
At public 4-year institutions
−4.0 pp since 2015

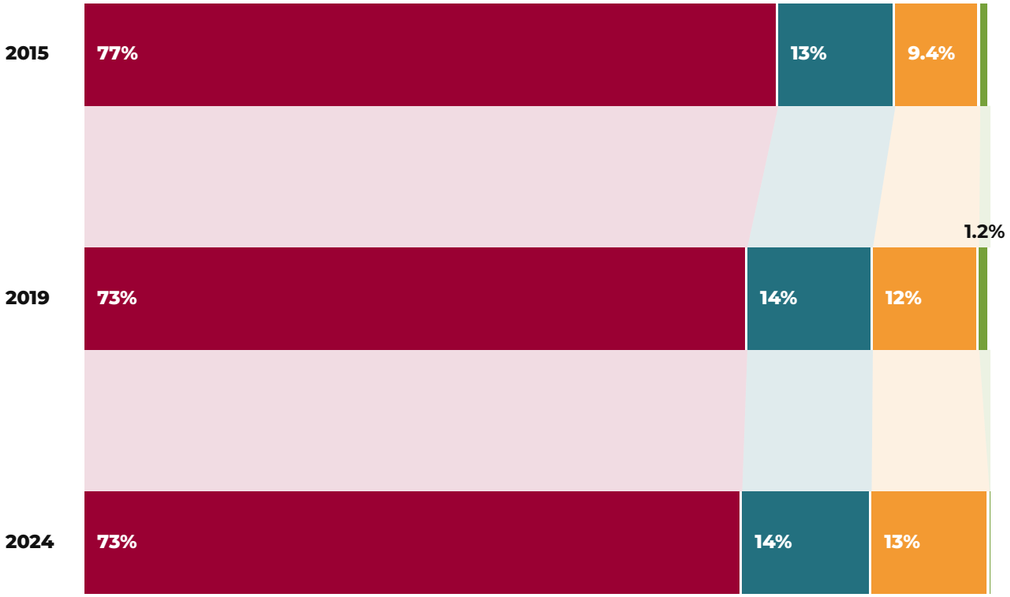
14%
At public 2-year institutions
+1.4 pp since 2015

In fall 2024, public 4-year institutions enrolled **73%** of students, down 4.0 points from 77% in 2015. Public 2-year institutions enrolled **14%** of students, up 1.4 points from 13% in 2015.

Private nonprofit institutions enrolled **13%** of students, up 3.7 points from 9.4% in 2015, and for-profit institutions enrolled **0.1%** of students, down 1.0 point from 1.1% in 2015.

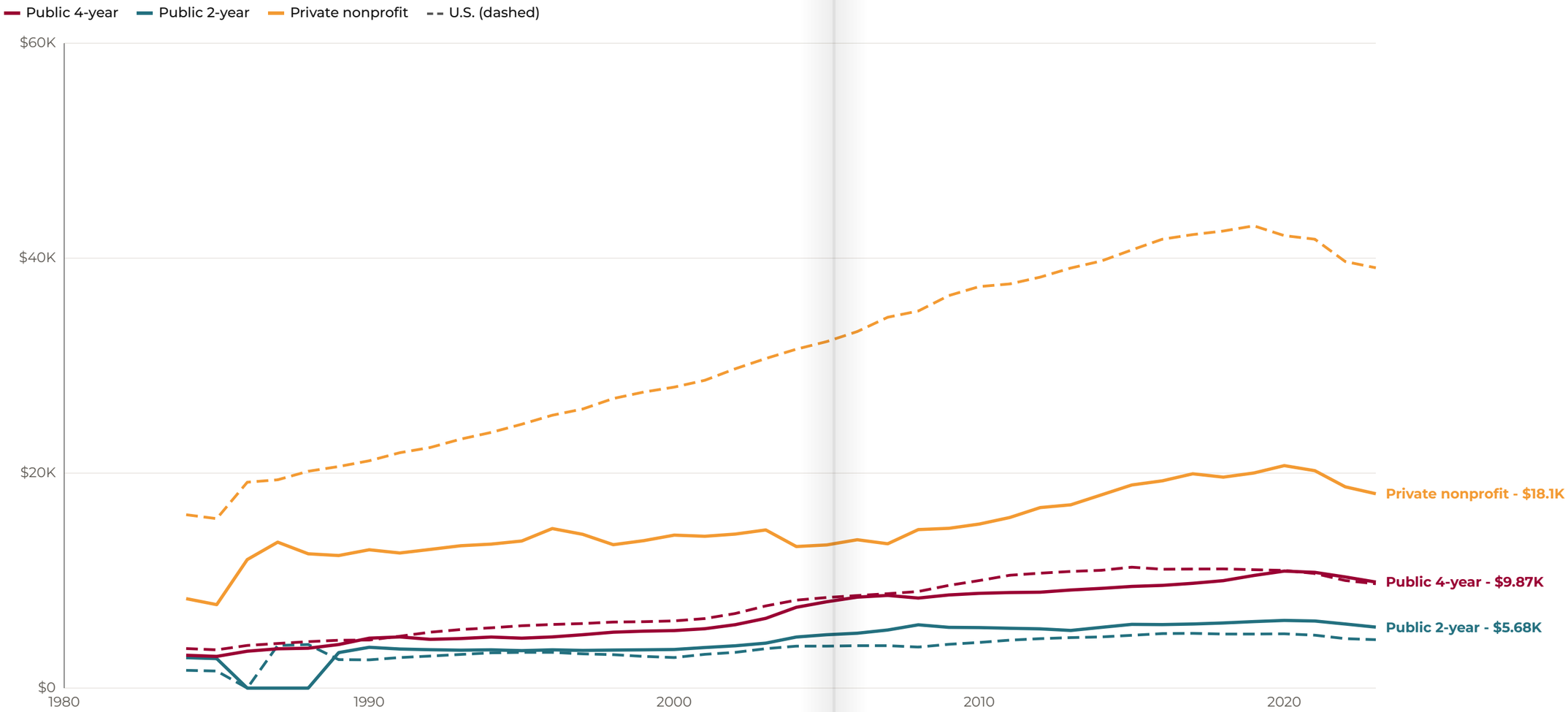
Public institutions together enrolled **87%** of students, against 73% nationally, 12th among the states.

Figure 33 Where Do Students Enroll?



Share of fall headcount enrollment by sector, 2015, 2019, 2024. Sectors as IPEDS classifies them each year. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 34 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at North Dakota's public four-year institutions are $9.87K (2023, 2024 dollars), close to the U.S. figure ($9.71K); the state ranks 28th of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $11.9K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (16th of 51), and net tuition makes up 48% of net tuition plus state and local appropriations (U.S. 43%).

$9.87K

In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023

U.S. **$9.71K** · **28th** of 51 · +4.3% since 2015

$11.9K

Appropriations per student, 2024

U.S. **$11.4K** · **16th** of 51 · −0.6% since 2015

48%

Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024

U.S. **43%** · **21st** of 51 · +1.3 pp since 2015

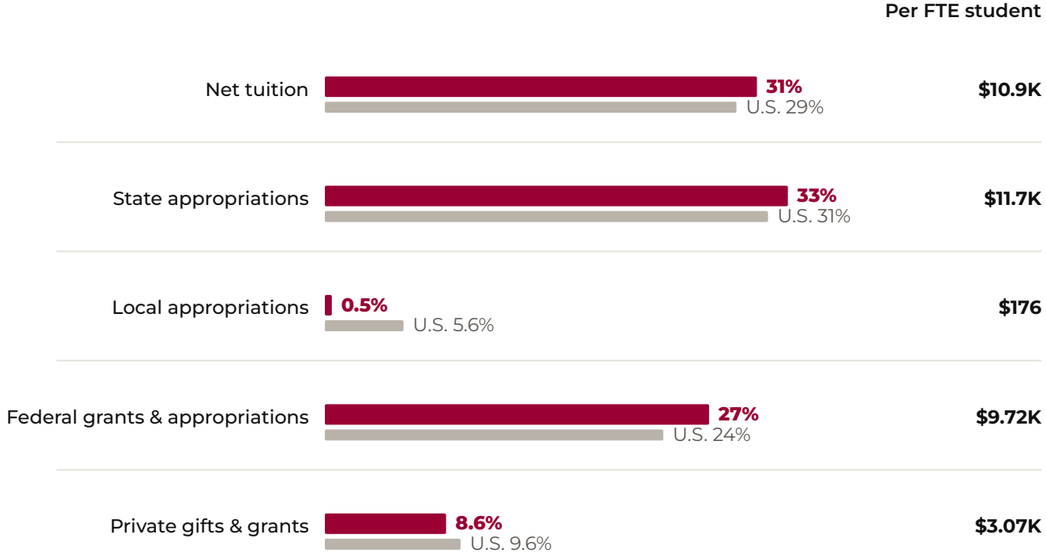
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

How Are North Dakota's Public Institutions Funded, and What Do They Produce?

The bars give each source's share of the core revenue of North Dakota's public institutions, with the nation for comparison, and at right the dollars per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student it provides. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

Net tuition per FTE student. The figure was $10.9K in FY2024, against $8.96K for the U.S., down 5.7% from $11.6K in FY2023 and up 4.7% since FY2015, when it was $10.4K.

Figure 35 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



Share of core revenue per FTE student by source, public institutions, FY2024; dollars per FTE at right, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Shares are of all five sources; the tuition share elsewhere in this profile divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations only. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

$9.87K
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023
U.S. **$9.71K** · **28th** of 51

$11.9K
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · **16th** of 51

48%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024
U.S. **43%** · **21st** of 51

60%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **32nd** of 51

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in North Dakota: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

In-state tuition, public 4-year. The figure was $9.87K in 2023, against $9.71K for the U.S., 28th among the states, down 4.5% from $10.3K in 2022 and up 4.3% since 2015, when it was $9.46K.

Table 7 Money and Results

Measure	Year	North Dakota	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$9.87K**	$9.71K	28th of 51	+4.3%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$11.9K**	$11.4K	16th of 51	−0.6%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations	2024	**48%**	43%	21st of 51	+1.3 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**60%**	65%	32nd of 51	+9.2 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$82.6K**	$106K	42nd of 51	−7.4%

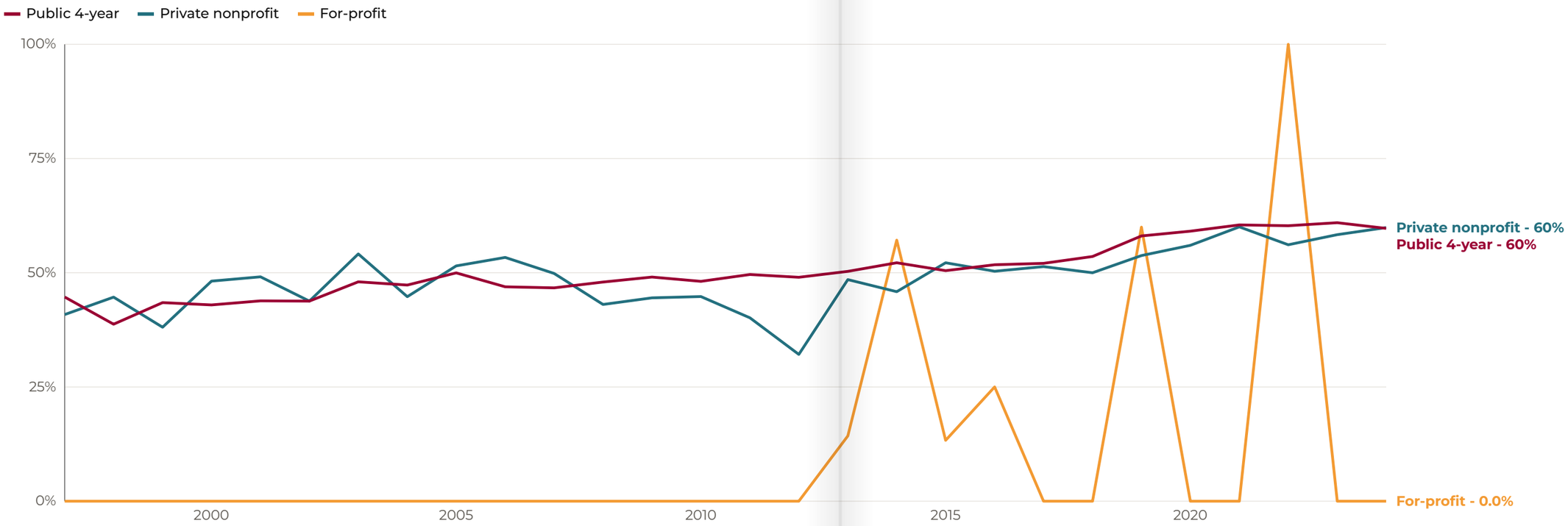
Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

North Dakota ranks 9th of 50 on the share of completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions, at 50% in 2024 against 41% for the U.S.

Figure 36 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

60% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in North Dakota graduated within six years (2024), 5.1 points below the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 32nd of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 60%, private nonprofit 60%, for-profit 0.0%. At two-year institutions, 50% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).

60%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **32nd** of 51 · +9.2 pp since 2015

50%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **9th** of 50 · +10.6 pp since 2015

13.9
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **14th** of 51 · +0.5 since 2015

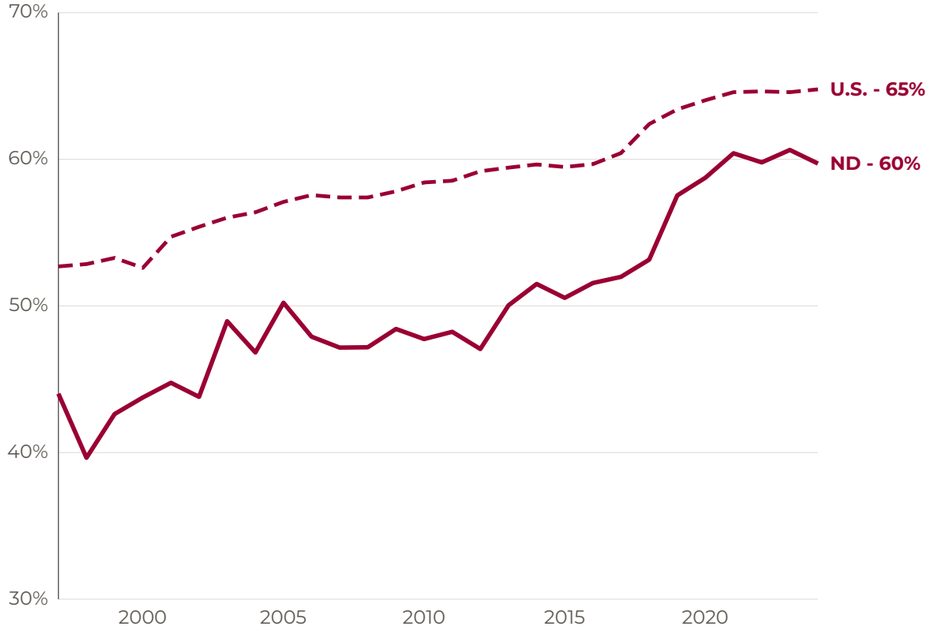
SECTION 14 · STUDENT OUTCOMES

How Many of North Dakota's Students Graduate?

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at North Dakota's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The rate leaves out students who start part-time (36% of the state's students attend part-time, against 39% nationally) and students who transfer and finish elsewhere. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Six-year graduation rate. The rate was 60% in 2024, against 65% for the U.S., down 0.9 points from 61% in 2023 and up 9.2 points since 2015, when it was 51%.

Figure 37 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

60%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **32nd** of 51

50%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **9th** of 50

13.9
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **14th** of 51

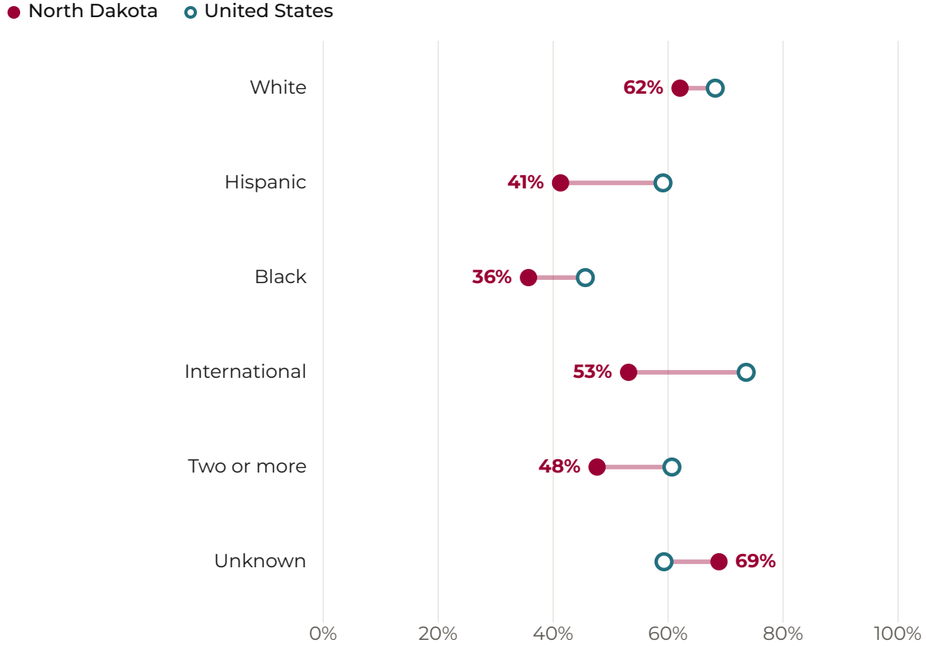
Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at North Dakota's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

White. The six-year rate was 62% in 2024, against 68% for the U.S.

Hispanic. The six-year rate was 41% in 2024, against 59% for the U.S.

Black. The six-year rate was 36% in 2024, against 46% for the U.S.

Figure 38 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

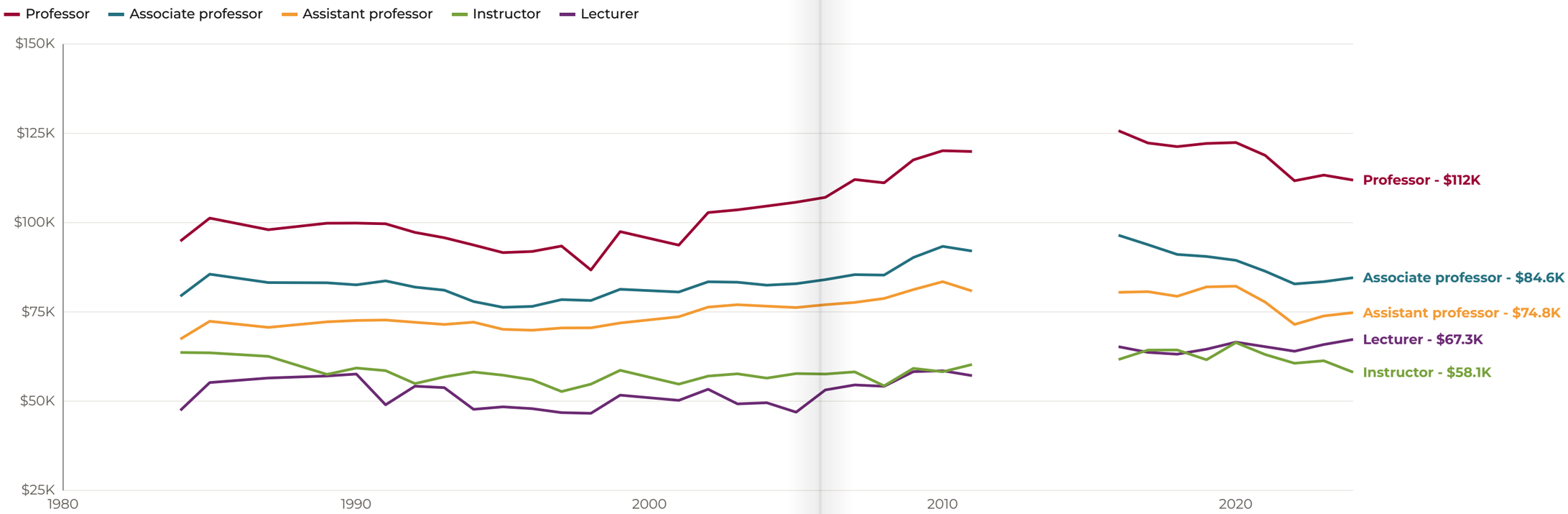
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SECTION 15

Faculty

North Dakota ranks 42nd of 51 on the average full-time faculty salary, at $82.6K in 2024 against $106K for the U.S.

Figure 39 What Do North Dakota's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at North Dakota's institutions earned an average of $82.6K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 22% below the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 42nd of 51. By rank (2024): professors $112K, associate professors $84.6K, assistant professors $74.8K, instructors $58.1K, lecturers $67.3K.

North Dakota's institutions had 2.25K full-time instructional staff in 2024, down 8% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 7% since 2016.

$82.6K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **42nd** of 51 · −7.4% since 2016

SECTION 15 · FACULTY

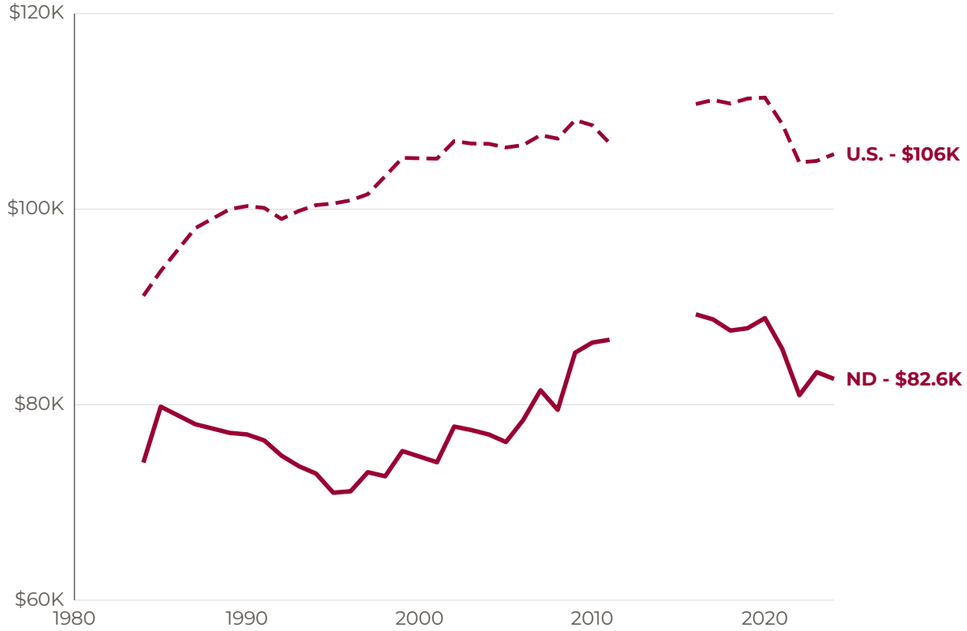
What Do North Dakota's Faculty Earn, and How Many Hold Tenure?

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at North Dakota's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Average salary. The figure was $82.6K in 2024, against $106K for the U.S., 42nd among the states, down 0.8% from $83.3K in 2023 and down 7.4% since 2016, when it was $89.2K.

Full-time instructional staff. The number was 2.25K in 2024, down 2.0% from 2.3K in 2023 and down 7.7% since 2015, when it was 2.44K.

Figure 40 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

$82.6K
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · **42nd** of 51

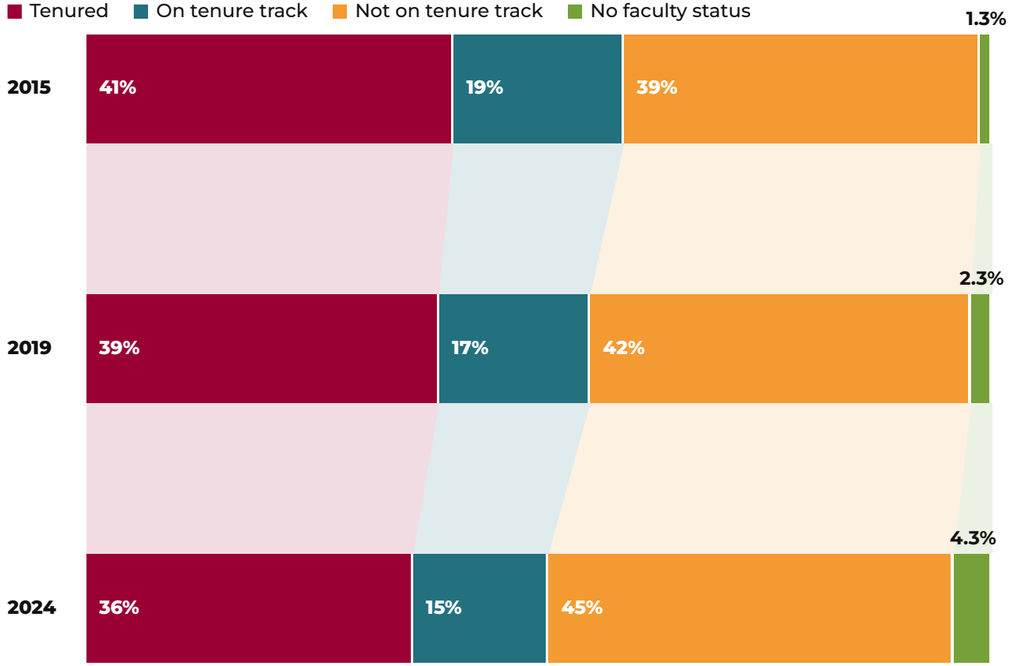
2.25K
Full-time instructional staff, 2024

36%
Tenured, 2024

The bars divide North Dakota's full-time instructional staff by tenure status in 2015, 2019 and 2024: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff. The share was 36% in 2024, down 0.9 points from 37% in 2023 and down 4.5 points since 2015, when it was 41%.

Figure 41 Tenure Status



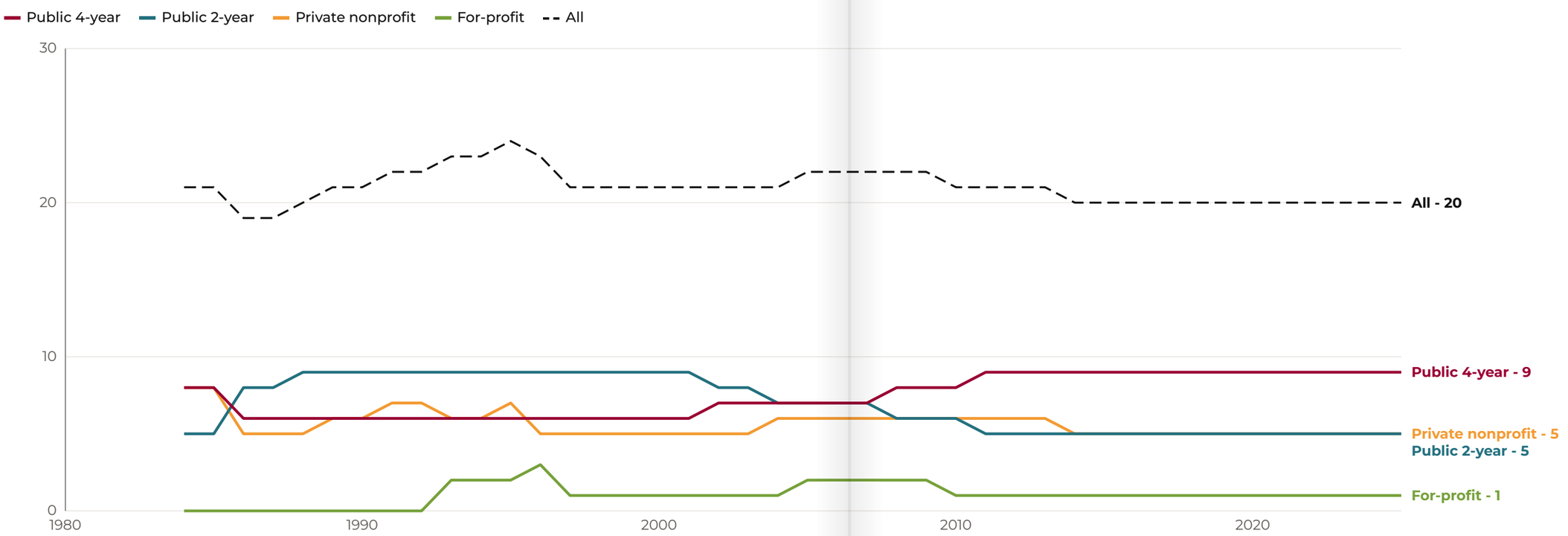
Full-time instructional staff by tenure status, 2015, 2019, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 16

Institutions

North Dakota ranks 42nd of 51 on the share of enrollment at for-profit institutions, at 0.1% in 2024 against 5.5% for the U.S.

Figure 42 How Many Institutions Does North Dakota Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

North Dakota has 20 degree-granting institutions:9 public 4-year, 5 public 2-year, 5 private nonprofit, 1 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is roughly flat since 2015. 87% of students attend public institutions and 0.1% attend for-profit ones.

87%

Students at public institutions, 2024

U.S. **73%** · **12th** of 51 · −2.6 pp since 2015

0.1%

Students at for-profit institutions, 2024

U.S. **5.5%** · **42nd** of 51 · −1.0 pp since 2015

26%

Students fully online, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **24th** of 51 · +1.8 pp since 2015

SECTION 16 · INSTITUTIONS

Which Institutions Lead in North Dakota?

The table lists North Dakota's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

Largest. The three largest were University of North Dakota (15K students), North Dakota State University-Main Campus (12K students), and Bismarck State College (4.21K students).

Degree-granting institutions. The state had 20 in 2025, and 20 of them reported the enrollment and degree data in these tables.

Table 8 What Are North Dakota's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
University of North Dakota	**15K**	12%	377	61%	77%
North Dakota State University-Main Campus	**12K**	33%	681	64%	95%
Bismarck State College	**4.21K**	–	13	–	–
University of Mary	**3.86K**	3.7%	89	67%	75%
North Dakota State College of Science	**3.37K**	–	–	–	–
Minot State University	**2.75K**	22%	43	45%	65%
Lake Region State College	**1.9K**	–	–	–	–
Valley City State University	**1.81K**	2.6%	15	53%	99%
Dickinson State University	**1.41K**	2.8%	21	48%	37%
University of Jamestown	**1.38K**	2.4%	32	49%	88%

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

20
Degree-granting institutions, 2025

87%
Students at public institutions, 2024
U.S. **73%** · **12th** of 51

0.1%
Students at for-profit institutions, 2024
U.S. **5.5%** · **42nd** of 51

26%
Students fully online, 2024
U.S. **27%** · **24th** of 51

Share of students at public institutions. The share was 87% in 2024, against 73% for the U.S., 12th among the states, down 0.4 points from 87% in 2023 and down 2.6 points since 2015, when it was 90%.

Share at for-profit institutions. The share was 0.1% in 2024, against 5.5% for the U.S., 42nd among the states, unchanged from 0.1% in 2023 and down 1.0 point since 2015, when it was 1.1%.

Table 9 North Dakota at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
Students at public institutions	90%	87% 2023	**87% 2024**	−2.6 pp	73%	12th
Students at for-profit institutions	1.1%	0.1% 2023	**0.1% 2024**	−1.0 pp	5.5%	42nd
Students fully online	24%	25% 2023	**26% 2024**	+1.8 pp	27%	24th

Data from NCES, IPEDS.

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

Tuition, appropriations, revenue and faculty salaries are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Research funding (HERD, Federal Funds, USAspending), wages and the NAFSA economic contribution are nominal dollars, and are labeled so. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions; the tuition share divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts. Year-to-year comparisons use one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November).

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally: a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size.

Sources

IPEDS (National Center for Education Statistics) is the backbone: Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. The profile also draws on NAEP, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates, Survey of Earned Doctorates, HERD and Federal Funds surveys, USAspending.gov, DHS SEVIS by the Numbers and ICE SEVIS releases, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification and BLS wage data, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, USPTO PatentsView, and other federal sources; every figure names its source, and the Sources page lists them in full. Generated November 2026.

NOTES

How the Numbers Are Counted

Ranks

Ranks are among the 50 states and the District of Columbia (1 = highest value, whether or not a high value is good). Where fewer than 51 report, the count is given ("23rd of 33").

Sectors

Sectors are as IPEDS classifies institutions each year. IPEDS moves a whole institution to "public, 4-year or above" once it awards any bachelor's degree, so community colleges that began offering applied bachelor's degrees carry all of their students into the public 4-year sector. Sector series (enrollment shares, public 4-year tuition, graduation rates by sector) reflect these moves.

Research doctorates

Two counts appear. IPEDS counts degrees institutions report as "doctor's degree, research/scholarship", which includes some practice-oriented degrees such as many Ed.D.s; the NSF Survey of Earned Doctorates counts research doctorate recipients and is smaller. Each figure names which it uses. "STEM master's per STEM research doctorate" divides IPEDS STEM master's degrees by IPEDS STEM research doctorates.

Engineering

"Engineering" alone is CIP 14. Where engineering technology (CIP 15) is added, the label says "engineering & eng. technology".

Graduation rates

IPEDS graduation rates follow first-time, full-time students and count only those who finish at the institution where they started, so they leave out part-time starters and students who transfer and finish elsewhere.

International students in SEVIS

SEVIS counts active F-1 and M-1 records, which include graduates on Optional Practical Training (up to 36 months for STEM graduates, 12 for others), so STEM shares run high. STEM follows the DHS STEM Designated Degree Program List, which is broader than the eight CIP families above, and DHS draws its STEM pages on a different basis from its all-student pages, so a country's STEM count can exceed its all-level count.

Visas and green cards

DOL labor condition applications (H-1B positions) are counted by worksite and include renewals and job changes; USCIS approvals are counted by the employer's address and split into new and continuing. PERM certifications are the employer's step toward a green card.

Patents

Patents are counted by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live; a company headquartered in another state takes its patents there.

Years

Each measure uses its latest year, so years differ across a page; every figure, table and statement gives its year, and lines that stop early are labeled with their last year.

North Dakota – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	288	**280**[2024]	−8.5 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#8	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	39%	**29%**[2024]	−9.7 pp ▼	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#21	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	245	**241**[2024]	−3.4 ▼	237	−2.5 ▼	#6	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	45%	**43%**[2024]	−1.8 pp ▼	39%	0.0 pp	#8	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	267	**257**[2024]	−9.6 ▼	257	−7.3 ▼	#24	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	34%	**25%**[2024]	−8.7 pp ▼	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#42	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	225	**216**[2024]	−9.2 ▼	214	−7.1 ▼	#21	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**161**[2015]	–	153	–	#7	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$16.9K	**$17.8K**[2021]	+5.7% ▲	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#18	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	87%	**85%**[2022]	−2.0 pp ▼	87%	+4.0 pp ▲	#31	[3]
Public high school graduates	6.96K	**7.37K**[2024]	+5.8% ▲	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#48	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$65.4K	**$61.2K**[2022]	−6.4% ▼	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#33	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	11.8	**12.4**[2022]	+0.6 ▲	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#43	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	109K	**120K**[2024]	+10% ▲	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#48	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	29%	**31%**[2023]	+1.6 pp ▲	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#46	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	2.9%	**3.3%**[2022]	+0.4 pp ▲	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#44	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	0.0%	**0.0%**[2020]	0.0 pp	6.8%	+1.4 pp ▲	#44	[3]
High schools offering calculus	34%[2016]	**21%**[2024]	−13.3 pp ▼	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#50	[14]
High schools offering physics	54%[2016]	**35%**[2024]	−19.2 pp ▼	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#48	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	78%[2016]	**73%**[2024]	−4.2 pp ▼	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#44	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	90%[2016]	**88%**[2024]	−2.0 pp ▼	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#31	[14]
High schools offering computer science	44%[2021]	**42%**[2024]	−2.1 pp ▼	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#41	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	19%[2016]	**20%**[2024]	+0.9 pp ▲	56%	0.0 pp	#51	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	6.7%[2021]	**3.1%**[2024]	−3.6 pp ▼	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#50	[14]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

NORTH DAKOTA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	82%[2016]	**79%[2024]**	−2.6 pp ▼	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#23	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	7.6[2016]	**9.8[2024]**	+2.1 ▲	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#50	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	3.0[2016]	**1.3[2024]**	−1.7 ▼	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#47	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	4.4[2016]	**3.7[2024]**	−0.7 ▼	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#42	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	21.6[2016]	**12.8[2024]**	−8.7 ▼	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#43	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	2.7[2016]	**2.6[2024]**	0.0	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#36	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	23%	**25%[2025]**	+1.8 pp ▲	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#50	[15]
Fall enrollment	53.8K	**53.5K[2024]**	−0.7% ▼	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#47	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	90%	**87%[2024]**	−2.6 pp ▼	73%	0.0 pp	#12	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	1.1%	**0.1%[2024]**	−1.0 pp ▼	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#42	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	30%	**36%[2024]**	+5.6 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#35	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	13%	**15%[2024]**	+2.0 pp ▲	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#27	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	24%	**26%[2024]**	+1.8 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#24	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	175	**209[2025]**	+19% ▲	59K	+7.3% ▲	#43	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	127	**157[2025]**	+24% ▲	44.4K	+14% ▲	#42	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	0.3%	**0.4%[2025]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#43	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	34	**60[2025]**	–	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#35	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	8	**11[2025]**	–	5.07K	+33% ▲	#44	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	2.7	**2.8[2025]**	0.0	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#47	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	20%	**21%[2025]**	+0.2 pp ▲	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#37	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	1.9%	**3.1%[2025]**	+1.2 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#48	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	9.5%	**9.2%[2025]**	−0.3 pp ▼	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#6	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	0.7%	**0.6%[2025]**	−0.2 pp ▼	1.2%	0.0 pp	#47	[4]

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NORTH DAKOTA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	4.9%	**5.0%**[2025]	+0.1 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#47	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	1.5%	**0.7%**[2025]	−0.8 pp ▼	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#49	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	14%	**13%**[2025]	−0.2 pp ▼	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#17	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	18%	**19%**[2025]	+1.1 pp ▲	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#28	[4]
STEM share of master's	14%	**18%**[2025]	+4.0 pp ▲	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#30	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	1.0%	**3.0%**[2025]	+2.0 pp ▲	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#44	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	6.0%	**6.0%**[2025]	+0.1 pp ▲	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#25	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	0.9%	**0.7%**[2025]	−0.2 pp ▼	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#35	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	1.7%	**3.4%**[2025]	+1.7 pp ▲	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#12	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	1.3%	**1.0%**[2025]	−0.3 pp ▼	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#21	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	20%	**18%**[2025]	−2.4 pp ▼	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#10	[4]
Share of master's in business	19%	**17%**[2025]	−2.5 pp ▼	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#41	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	46%	**39%**[2025]	−7.1 pp ▼	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#33	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	0.5%	**1.6%**[2025]	+1.1 pp ▲	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#42	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	16%	**18%**[2025]	+2.0 pp ▲	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#9	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	2.6%	**2.6%**[2025]	0.0 pp	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#25	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	15%	**8.0%**[2025]	−6.5 pp ▼	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#39	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	12%	**8.3%**[2025]	−3.6 pp ▼	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#23	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	2.6%	**22%**[2025]	+19.8 pp ▲	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#8	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	1.6%	**2.9%**[2025]	+1.3 pp ▲	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#32	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	13.5	**13.9**[2025]	+0.5 ▲	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#14	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	2.3%[2016]	**3.3%**[2024]	+1.0 pp ▲	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#17	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	96	**122**[2025]	+27% ▲	117K	2.18× ▲	#42	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	0.2%	**0.1%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#42	[4]

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NORTH DAKOTA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	3.9%	**2.7%**[2024]	−1.2 pp ▼	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#22	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	15%	**16%**[2024]	+1.3 pp ▲	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#20	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	4.8%	**3.2%**[2025]	−1.6 pp ▼	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#26	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	7.1%	**4.2%**[2025]	−3.0 pp ▼	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#34	[4]
International share of all master's	13%	**13%**[2025]	+0.2 pp ▲	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#29	[4]
International share of STEM master's	39%	**36%**[2025]	−3.5 pp ▼	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#35	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences master's	90%[2017]	**40%**[2025]	−50.3 pp ▼	65%	+0.6 pp ▲	#37	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	58%	**49%**[2025]	−8.7 pp ▼	50%	+0.9 pp ▲	#17	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	39%[2016]	**37%**[2025]	−2.2 pp ▼	23%	+6.9 pp ▲	#3	[4]
International share of physical sciences master's	–	**13%**[2018]	–	29%	–	#38	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	43%	**33%**[2025]	−9.8 pp ▼	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#6	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	65%	**57%**[2025]	−8.6 pp ▼	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#2	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology research doctorates	87%	**69%**[2025]	−17.6 pp ▼	55%	−1.0 pp ▼	#3	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences research doctorates	27%[2016]	**43%**[2020]	+16.2 pp ▲	26%	−1.0 pp ▼	#3	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	2.6K	**2.41K**[2026]	−7.5% ▼	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#46	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.2%	**0.2%**[2026]	0.0 pp	–	–	#46	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	12%	**7.8%**[2026]	−4.1 pp ▼	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#43	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	21%	**3.8%**[2026]	−17.7 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#45	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	40%	**34%**[2026]	−5.8 pp ▼	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#32	[20]
Countries of citizenship represented	111	**117**[2026]	+5.4% ▲	219	−2.7% ▼	#47	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	1.06K	**1.45K**[2026]	+37% ▲	749K	+61% ▲	#44	[20]
Active STEM master's students	293	**375**[2026]	+28% ▲	393K	+90% ▲	#45	[20]
Active STEM doctoral students	392	**643**[2026]	+64% ▲	158K	+61% ▲	#41	[20]
Share of STEM master's students from India	38%	**34%**[2026]	−4.6 pp ▼	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#44	[20]

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NORTH DAKOTA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	595[2017]	**280[2024]**	−53% ▼	–	–	#50	[1]
Economic contribution of international students, nominal dollars	$53.4M[2018]	**$56.7M[2024]**	+6.2% ▲	$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#48	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	471[2018]	**351[2024]**	−25% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#46	[2]
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.3%[2024]**	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#42	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.3%[2024]**	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#41	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.2%[2024]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#50	[16]
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	1K	**582[2025]**	−42% ▼	275K	−14% ▼	#50	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	1.85K	**1.98K[2016]**	+7.1% ▲	620K	+0.4% ▲	#41	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	701	**677[2016]**	−3.4% ▼	241K	+2.3% ▲	#41	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	38%	**34%[2016]**	−3.7 pp ▼	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#26	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	61%	**58%[2016]**	−2.8 pp ▼	57%	0.0 pp	#19	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	79	**82[2016]**	+3.8% ▲	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#44	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	68%	**40%[2016]**	−28.1 pp ▼	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#44	[9]
University R&D spending, nominal dollars	$218M	**$399M[2024]**	+83% ▲	$118B	+71% ▲	#43	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	0.3%	**0.3%[2024]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#43	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	34%	**36%[2024]**	+2.2 pp ▲	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#51	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	6.4%	**4.4%[2024]**	−2.0 pp ▼	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#24	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	28%	**23%[2024]**	−4.3 pp ▼	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#2	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science, nominal dollars	$4.95M	**$11.4M[2024]**	2.29× ▲	$5.12B	+97% ▲	#43	[6]
University R&D in engineering, nominal dollars	$46.2M	**$148M[2024]**	3.21× ▲	$19.3B	+74% ▲	#29	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	3.82K	**4.48K[2024]**	+17% ▲	1.09M	+20% ▲	#39	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$82M	**$210M[2024]**	2.56× ▲	$193B	+53% ▲	#48	[8]
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state, nominal dollars	$49.7M	**$119M[2024]**	2.40× ▲	$44.4B	+64% ▲	#44	[8]
Defense R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$2.56M	**$39.3M[2024]**	15.33× ▲	$97.2B	+60% ▲	#48	[8]

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NORTH DAKOTA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH (CONTINUED)							
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$16M	**$31.8M[2024]**	+99% ▲	$48.5B	+62% ▲	#47	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state, nominal dollars	$31.9M	**$60.6M[2025]**	+90% ▲	$45B	+47% ▲	#50	[19]
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state, nominal dollars	$2.45M	**$39.3M[2026]**	+36.9 ▲	$59.3B	+22,105.9 ▲	#36	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	$41.9K[2020]	**$50.3K[2022]**	+20% ▲	$47.5K	+11% ▲	#20	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**$57.3K[2025]**	–	$47.5K	–	#2	[15]
Median debt of completers, nominal dollars	$23.3K	**$20.5K[2024]**	−12% ▼	$17.6K	−4.6% ▼	#10	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$71.4K[2025]**	–	$68.2K	–	#10	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$54.4K[2025]**	–	$51.9K	–	#15	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**$68.6K[2025]**	–	$68.1K	–	#18	[15]
STEM master's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$60.6K[2025]**	–	$91.6K	–	#46	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	51%	**60%[2024]**	+9.2 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#32	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	40%	**50%[2024]**	+10.6 pp ▲	41%	+12.1 pp ▲	#9	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$9.46K	**$9.87K[2023]**	+4.3% ▲	$9.71K	−14% ▼	#28	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$12K	**$11.9K[2024]**	−0.6% ▼	$11.4K	+22% ▲	#16	[4]
Net tuition share of tuition plus state and local appropriations, public institutions	47%	**48%[2024]**	+1.3 pp ▲	43%	−5.9 pp ▼	#21	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$89.2K[2016]	**$82.6K[2024]**	−7.4% ▼	$106K	−4.6% ▼	#42	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	38%	**39%[2016]**	+1.2 pp ▲	44%	−1.8 pp ▼	#20	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	41%	**46%[2016]**	+4.6 pp ▲	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#25	[21]
OPT retention, master's graduates	31%	**35%[2016]**	+3.5 pp ▲	39%	−2.5 pp ▼	#23	[21]
OPT retention, STEM graduates	29%	**25%[2016]**	−3.6 pp ▼	37%	−1.9 pp ▼	#29	[21]
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	0.64	**0.66[2016]**	0.0	1.00	0.0	#33	[21]

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NORTH DAKOTA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	87	**76**[2016]	−13% ▼	41.2K	+51% ▲	#42	[21]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	+2.9	**+1.7**[2025]	−1.2 ▼	–	–	#23	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	−94	**+412**[2025]	+506.0 ▲	–	–	#21	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	3.9%	**2.6%**[2025]	−1.3 pp ▼	–	–	#30	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	3.6%	**2.4%**[2025]	−1.2 pp ▼	–	–	#35	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	781	**1.03K**[2025]	+32% ▲	–	–	#47	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	51%[2016]	**50%**[2024]	−1.0 pp ▼	–	–	#47	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	+42[2016]	**+42**[2024]	+0.2 ▲	–	–	#5	[4]
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	24%[2016]	**25%**[2022]	+1.2 pp ▲	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#24	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	1.13K	**573**[2025]	−49% ▼	914K	−24% ▼	#46	[17]
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	0.1%	**0.1%**[2025]	0.0 pp	–	–	#46	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	73%	**29%**[2025]	−44.4 pp ▼	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#46	[17]
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$66.2K	**$70.7K**[2025]	+6.8% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#50	[17]
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	46%	**5.9%**[2025]	−40.1 pp ▼	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#45	[17]
Green-card labor certifications	71	**304**[2025]	4.28× ▲	138K	+75% ▲	#40	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	30%	**3.5%**[2024]	−26.1 pp ▼	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#49	[17]
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	2.9%	**12%**[2024]	+9.5 pp ▲	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#15	[17]
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	32%	**12%**[2024]	−20.4 pp ▼	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#47	[17]
STEM share of PERM certifications	36%	**9.2%**[2025]	−27.0 pp ▼	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#48	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$86.7K	**$41.1K**[2025]	−53% ▼	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#42	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	1.6K	**1.61K**[2024]	+0.6% ▲	1.36M	+30% ▲	#44	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	0.2%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#44	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	561	**1.18K**[2024]	2.10× ▲	819K	+12% ▲	#44	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#44	[16]

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NORTH DAKOTA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.2%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#41	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#47	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.3%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#34	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	0.0%	**0.0%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#49	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	84	**112**[2026]	+33% ▲	127K	+14% ▲	#46	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	121	**182**[2026]	+50% ▲	268K	+52% ▲	#45	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	0.1%	**0.1%**[2026]	0.0 pp	–	–	#46	[13]
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	5.6%	**4.3%**[2026]	−1.3 pp ▼	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#13	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	46%	**50%**[2026]	+3.6 pp ▲	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#3	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	12%	**16%**[2026]	+4.2 pp ▲	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#41	[13]
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	56%	**45%**[2026]	−11.3 pp ▼	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#16	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							
Workers in STEM occupations	19.7K	**22.7K**[2024]	+15% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#50	[12]
STEM workers as a share of all workers	4.9%	**5.4%**[2024]	+0.5 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#45	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	4.3%	**3.8%**[2024]	−0.6 pp ▼	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#49	[12]
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	3.7%	**2.3%**[2024]	−1.4 pp ▼	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#49	[12]
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	3.4%	**2.2%**[2024]	−1.1 pp ▼	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#47	[12]
Foreign-born share of residents	3.8%	**6.0%**[2025]	+2.3 pp ▲	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#36	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	9.1%	**12%**[2025]	+2.5 pp ▲	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#29	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	17.6K	**18.8K**[2025]	+7.4% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#49	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	0.66	**0.66**[2025]	0.0	1.00	0.0	#46	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$67.2K	**$91.6K**[2025]	+36% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#47	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$84.3K[2019]	**$106K**[2025]	+25% ▲	$136K	+26% ▲	#46	[10]
Software developer jobs	1.61K	**1.45K**[2025]	−9.9% ▼	1.69M	+48% ▲	#50	[10]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

NORTH DAKOTA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION (CONTINUED)							
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal, nominal dollars	$45.7K	**$64K**^{2025}	+40% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#31	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	51	**74**^{2025}	+47% ▲	135K	−0.6% ▼	#46	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	0.0%	**0.1%**^{2025}	0.0 pp	–	–	#46	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	7.7%	**12%**^{2025}	+4.5 pp ▲	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#38	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	5.8%	**8.1%**^{2025}	+2.3 pp ▲	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#48	[22]
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	0.0%	**1.4%**^{2025}	+1.4 pp ▲	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#15	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	4.1%	**7.4%**^{2025}	+3.3 pp ▲	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#49	[22]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). “pp” is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

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